“Śrī Caitanya-caritāmṛta”

Antya-līlā

Chapter 5

The Story of Pradyumna Miśra

(English translation from the Bengali, following the Gauḍīya Maṭha edition and the «Anubhāṣya», 2026 — draft)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya

Summary. Pradyumna Miśra, a resident of Śrīhaṭṭa, wished to hear talks about Kṛṣṇa from Mahāprabhu, and the Lord sent him to Rāmānanda. Hearing how Rāmānanda dealt with the *devadāsīs*, Miśra came back. Mahāprabhu then explained to him well the truth about Rāmānanda, and Miśra went again and received instruction in the truth from Rāmānanda. A *brāhmaṇa* from Bengal composed a play about Mahāprabhu's pastimes and brought it. Svarūpa Gosvāmī heard it and pointed out the fault of Māyāvāda in it, yet he gave the poet's verses a second meaning and so pleased him. His life's purpose fulfilled, the poet gave up everything and stayed in Nīlācala under the shelter of the Vaiṣṇavas.

*For the *jīva* bereft of consciousness (*a-caitanya*), stricken with the disease of worldly existence and fallen into the ocean of *saṁsāra*, the only good lies in taking shelter of Caitanya's feet —*

বৈগুণ্যকীটকলিতঃ পৈশুন্য-ব্রণপীড়িতঃ ।
দৈন্যার্ণবে নিমগ্নোঽহং চৈতন্য-বৈদ্যমাশ্রয়ে ॥ ১ ॥

vaiguṇya-kīṭa-kalitaḥ
by the ripening of karma by the worm bitten
paiśunya-vraṇa-pīḍitaḥ
of malice by the sore afflicted
dainyārṇave nimagno 'haṁ
in the ocean of humility sunk I
caitanya-vaidyam āśraye
Caitanya the physician I take shelter of

1 Bitten by the worm of ripened karma, tormented by the sore of malice, and sunk in an ocean of humility, I take shelter of Caitanya, the physician.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Bitten by the worm of *vaiguṇya*, tormented by envy and sunk in an ocean of humility, I have taken shelter of the physician, Caitanya.

Anubhāṣya.
vaiguṇya-kīṭa-kalitaḥ (*vaiguṇya* is the ripening of karma; bitten by the worm that it is) **paiśunya-vraṇa-pīḍitaḥ** (*paiśunya* is malice; suffering from the sore, that is, the wound, that it is) **dainyārṇave** (in the ocean of humility) **nimagnaḥ aham caitanya-vaidyam** (the physician, Mahāprabhu) **āśraye** (I have taken shelter).

জয় জয় শচীসুত শ্রীকৃষ্ণচৈতন্য ।
জয় জয় কৃপাময় নিত্যানন্দ ধন্য ॥ ২ ॥

jaya jaya śacīsuta śrīkṛṣṇacaitanya
glory glory to the son of Śacī to Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya
jaya jaya kṛpāmaya nityānanda dhanya
glory glory to the all-merciful Nityānanda the blessed

2 Glory, glory to Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya, the son of Śacī! Glory, glory to the all-merciful, blessed Nityānanda!

জয়াদ্বৈত কৃপাসিন্ধু জয় ভক্তগণ ।
জয় স্বরূপ, গদাধর, রূপ, সনাতন ॥ ৩ ॥

jayādvaita kṛpā-sindhu jaya bhakta-gaṇa
glory to Advaita of mercy the ocean glory to the devotees all
jaya svarūpa, gadādhara, rūpa, sanātana
glory to Svarūpa Gadādhara Rūpa Sanātana

3 Glory to Advaita, the ocean of mercy! Glory to all the devotees! Glory to Svarūpa, Gadādhara, Rūpa and Sanātana!

The Lord's conversation with Pradyumna Miśra; Miśra humbly asks the Lord to let him hear about Kṛṣṇa —

একদিন প্রদ্যুম্ন-মিশ্র প্রভুর চরণে ।
দণ্ডবৎ করি' কিছু করে নিবেদনে ॥ ৪ ॥

ekadina pradyumna-miśra prabhura caraṇe
one day Pradyumna Miśra of the Lord at the feet
daṇḍavat kari' kichu kare nivedane
obeisance making something he makes submission

4 One day Pradyumna Miśra bowed down at the Lord's feet and humbly made a request.

শুন, প্রভু, মুঞি দীন গৃহস্থ অধম !
কোন ভাগ্যে পাঞাছোঁ তোমার দুর্ল্লভ চরণ ॥ ৫ ॥

śuna, prabhu, muñi dīna gṛhastha adhama!
hear O Lord I wretched householder lowly
kona bhāgye pāñāchoṁ tomāra durlabha caraṇa
by what fortune I have obtained Your rare feet

5 "Hear me, O Lord: I am a wretched, lowly householder. By what fortune have I obtained Your feet, so rarely attained?

কৃষ্ণকথা শুনিবারে মোর ইচ্ছা হয় ।
কৃষ্ণকথা কহ মোরে হঞা সদয় ॥ ৬ ॥

kṛṣṇa-kathā śunibāre mora icchā haya
about Kṛṣṇa talks to hear my desire is
kṛṣṇa-kathā kaha more hañā sadaya
about Kṛṣṇa talks tell me becoming kind

6 I wish to hear talks about Kṛṣṇa. Be kind to me and tell me about Kṛṣṇa."

*Pretending to know nothing, the Lord tells Miśra, born in a family of *brāhmaṇas* by seed (*śaukra*), to go as a disciple eager to hear to Rāmānanda, the guru of all four *varṇas* and *āśramas*, who was not born in a family of *brāhmaṇas* by seed —*

প্রভু কহেন, — কৃষ্ণকথা আমি নাহি জানি ।
সবে রামানন্দ জানে, তাঁর মুখে শুনি ॥ ৭ ॥

prabhu kahena, — kṛṣṇa-kathā āmi nāhi jāni
the Lord says about Kṛṣṇa talks I not know
sabe rāmānanda jāne, tāṁra mukhe śuni
only Rāmānanda knows his from the mouth I hear

7 The Lord said, "I know nothing of talks about Kṛṣṇa. Only Rāmānanda knows them, and I hear them from his lips.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Prabhu kahena: Mahāprabhu said.

Praise of the good fortune of one who wishes to hear about Kṛṣṇa —

ভাগ্যে তোমার কৃষ্ণকথা শুনিতে হয় মন ।
রামানন্দ-পাশ যাই' করহ শ্রবণ ॥ ৮ ॥

bhāgye tomāra kṛṣṇa-kathā śunite haya mana
by fortune your about Kṛṣṇa talks to hear is the mind
rāmānanda-pāśa yāi' karaha śravaṇa
to Rāmānanda going do hearing

8 It is your good fortune that your mind longs to hear about Kṛṣṇa. Go to Rāmānanda and hear from him.

The definition of one who is truly fortunate —

কৃষ্ণকথায় রুচি তোমার — বড় ভাগ্যবান্ ।
যার কৃষ্ণকথায় রুচি, সেই ভাগ্যবান্ ॥ ৯ ॥

kṛṣṇa-kathāya ruci tomāra — baḍa bhāgyavān
for talks about Kṛṣṇa taste your very fortunate
yāra kṛṣṇa-kathāya ruci, sei bhāgyavān
whose for talks about Kṛṣṇa taste he fortunate

9 You have a taste for talks about Kṛṣṇa — you are greatly fortunate! Whoever has such a taste is truly fortunate."

*Without *rati* for Kṛṣṇa — the *bhakti* that is the goal (*sādhya-bhakti*) — the practice of prescribed *dharma* is fruitless — (*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 1.2.8)*

ধর্ম্মঃ স্বনুষ্ঠিতঃ পুংসাং বিষ্বক্সেনকথাসু যঃ ।
নোৎপাদয়েদ্যদি রতিং শ্রম এব হি কেবলম্ ॥ ১০ ॥

dharmaḥ sv-anuṣṭhitaḥ puṁsāṁ
dharma well performed of people
viṣvaksena-kathāsu yaḥ
of Viṣvaksena for the narrations which
notpādayed yadi ratiṁ
not awakens if attraction
śrama eva hi kevalam
labor only certainly merely

10 "Dharma, however well a person performs it, is nothing but wasted labour if it does not awaken attraction (*rati*) to the narrations about the Lord, Viṣvaksena." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 1.2.8)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

A person may perform the *dharma* of the *varṇas* and *āśramas* in the best way. But if it does not awaken in him attraction (*rati*) for talks about Kṛṣṇa, even that *dharma* is only wasted labor.

Anubhāṣya.

At the beginning of their hearing the *Bhāgavatam* from Śrī Sūta, the disciple of Śrī Śukadeva, Śaunaka and the other sages asked him six questions. The first was: “What is the absolute (*aikāntika*) highest good of man?” Answering it, Sūta explains that man's duty is to worship Adhokṣaja, and along the way he tells how prescribed *dharma* gains its purpose:

puṁsām (of people) **yaḥ sv-anuṣṭhitaḥ** (the *dharma* well performed — the observance of divine *varṇāśrama* and the like — even when it takes the form of *sādhana-bhakti*) **yadi viṣvaksena-kathāsu** (for the narrations about Viṣvaksena, Bhagavān, and about the *bhāgavatas*, that is, for the *kīrtana* of His name, form, qualities, pastimes and so on) **ratim** (taste) **na utpādayet** (does not awaken, then that *svadharma*) **kevalam** (entirely) **hi** (certainly) **śramaḥ eva** (wasted labor, fruitless: that *dharma* has not the slightest result; it is certainly useless — this is the meaning), for it is said: “If a man's work in this world does not lead to *dharma*, his *dharma* to detachment, and his detachment to the service of the feet of Him whose feet are holy places, then though he lives, he is dead.” (*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 3.23.56)

Pradyumna Miśra goes to the house of Rāmānanda, who is absorbed in direct service to Śrī Rādhā-Govinda; Rāya's servant receives him —

তবে প্রদ্যুম্ন-মিশ্র গেলা রামানন্দের স্থানে ।
রায়ের সেবক তাঁরে বসাইল আসনে ॥ ১১ ॥

tabe pradyumna-miśra gelā rāmānandera sthāne
then Pradyumna Miśra went Rāmānanda’s to the place
rāyera sevaka tāṁre vasāila āsane
Rāya’s servant him seated on a seat

11 Then Pradyumna Miśra went to Rāmānanda’s house, and Rāya’s servant offered him a seat.

*At Miśra's question the servant tells what Rāya — a *mahā-bhāgavata*, a *paramahaṁsa*, an *ātmārāma* — is doing —*

রায়ের দর্শন না পাঞা সেবকে পুছিল ।
রায়ের বৃত্তান্ত সেবক কহিতে লাগিল ॥ ১২ ॥

rāyera darśana nā pāñā sevake puchila
Rāya's sight not getting the servant he asked
rāyera vṛttānta sevaka kahite lāgila
Rāya's doings the servant to tell began

12 Not seeing Rāya, he asked the servant, who told him what Rāya was doing:

দুই দেব-কন্যা হয় পরম-সুন্দরী ।
নৃত্য-গীতে সুনিপুণা, বয়সে কিশোরী ॥ ১৩ ॥

dui deva-kanyā haya parama-sundarī
two maidens of the Deity there are supremely beautiful
nṛtya-gīte sunipuṇā, vayase kiśorī
in dance and song very skilled in age in early youth

13 "There are two maidens of the Deity (*deva-kanyās*), supremely beautiful, very skilled in dance and song, and in the bloom of youth.

সেই দুঁহে লঞা রায় নিভৃত উদ্যানে ।
নিজ-নাটক-গীতের শিখায় নর্ত্তনে ॥ ১৪ ॥

sei duṁhe lañā rāya nibhṛta udyāne
those two taking Rāya in a secluded garden
nija-nāṭaka-gītera śikhāya nartane
of his own drama's songs he teaches dancing

14 Rāya has taken them both to a secluded garden and is teaching them to dance to the songs of his own drama.

Anubhāṣya.
Nija-nāṭaka (his own play): the play *Jagannātha-vallabha*, which Śrī Rāmānanda Rāya wrote in Sanskrit.

Miśra is asked to sit for a while —

তুমি ইঁহা বসি' রহ, ক্ষণেকে আসিবেন ।
তাঁরে যেই আজ্ঞা দেহ', সেই করিবেন ॥ ১৫ ॥

tumi iṁhā vasi' raha, kṣaṇeke āsibena
you here sitting stay in a moment he will come
tāṁre yei ājñā deha', sei karibena
to him whatever order you give that he will do

15 Please sit here and wait; he will come shortly. Whatever you ask of him, he will do."

Miśra waits —

তবে প্রদ্যুম্ন-মিশ্র তাঁহা রহিল বসিয়া ।
রামানন্দ নিভৃতে সেই দুই-জন লঞা ॥ ১৬ ॥

tabe pradyumna-miśra tāṁhā rahila vasiyā
then Pradyumna Miśra there remained sitting
rāmānanda nibhṛte sei dui-jana lañā
Rāmānanda in seclusion those two taking

16 So Pradyumna Miśra stayed there, waiting, while Rāmānanda, in a secluded place, attended to the two maidens.

*The *ātmārāma* Rāmānanda serves Śrī Rādhā directly; that service is spiritual —*

স্বহস্তে করেন তার অভ্যঙ্গ-মর্দ্দন ।
স্বহস্তে করান স্নান, গাত্র সংমার্জ্জন ॥ ১৭ ॥

sva-haste karena tāra abhyaṅga-mardana
with his own hands he does their anointing with oil
sva-haste karāna snāna, gātra saṁmārjana
with his own hands he gives a bath the body cleansing

17 With his own hands he anointed them with oil; with his own hands he bathed them and cleansed their bodies.

Anubhāṣya.
Abhyaṅga-mardana: anointing with oil.

স্বহস্তে পরান বস্ত্র, সর্ব্বাঙ্গ মণ্ডন ।
তবু নির্ব্বিকার রায়-রামানন্দের মন ॥ ১৮ ॥

sva-haste parāna vastra, sarvāṅga maṇḍana
with his own hands he puts on clothes every limb adorning
tabu nirvikāra rāya-rāmānandera mana
yet unmoved of Rāya Rāmānanda the mind

18 With his own hands he dressed them and adorned every limb, and yet the mind of Rāya Rāmānanda remained unmoved.

Anubhāṣya.

Maṇḍana: adorning with ornaments and the like. **Nirvikāra**: Rāmānanda Prabhu sees Śrī Rādhā-Kṛṣṇa, who are beyond the senses (*adhokṣaja*), everywhere (see Madhya 8.273, 274 and 276); he is the crest-jewel of the *paramahaṁsas* and the guru even of the *vidvat-sannyāsīs*. He did not behave like worldly men who think themselves male enjoyers: on seeing women and the like, he did not turn to material enjoyment for the gratification of his own senses, nor did he fall prey to agitation of body or mind.

*The nature of Śrī Rāmānanda Gosvāmī, the crest-jewel of the *vidvat-sannyāsīs*, detached from material enjoyment, who has conquered the six urges (*vega*) —*

কাষ্ঠ-পাষাণ-স্পর্শে হয় যৈছে ভাব ।
তরুণী-স্পর্শে রামানন্দের তৈছে ‘স্বভাব’ ॥ ১৯ ॥

kāṣṭha-pāṣāṇa-sparśe haya yaiche bhāva
wood and stone at touching there is as feeling
taruṇī-sparśe rāmānandera taiche ‘svabhāva’
a young woman at touching Rāmānanda’s so nature

19 What one feels on touching wood or stone, Rāmānanda by nature feels on touching a young woman.

*In his transcendental perfected body (*siddha-deha*), full of spiritual bliss, the *mahā-bhāgavata* Rāya, following *rāgātmikā-bhakti* in the mood of a gopī,*

serves his mistress, Śrī Rādhā, in her transcendental spiritual pastimes —

সেব্য-বুদ্ধি আরোপিয়া করেন সেবন ।
স্বাভাবিক দাসীভাব করেন আরোপণ ॥ ২০ ॥

sevya-buddhi āropiyā karena sevana
the sense of the one to be served attributing he does service
svābhāvika dāsī-bhāva karena āropaṇa
natural maidservant's mood he does taking upon himself

20 Seeing in them the ones to be served (*sevya-buddhi*), he served them, assuming, as was natural to him, the mood of a maidservant.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Rāya Rāmānanda had composed a play called *Jagannātha-vallabha*. To stage it before Śrī Jagannāthadeva, he brought two *deva-kanyās*, that is, young *devadāsīs* (today they are called *māhārīs*), and was teaching them the mood of the gopīs that the play requires. These two girls were to act the pastimes of the chief gopīs. So he regarded them as the chief gopīs, the ones to be served (*sevya-buddhi*), took for himself the mood of a maidservant following them, and taught them the songs and other service for the coming performance. Śrī Rāmānanda knew himself to be Śrīmatī's maidservant. Seeing in the actresses of Śrīmatī's role the one he serves, he cared for their bodies, adorned them and so on.

*The glory of Gaura's devotees is inconceivable; among them, in Śrī Rāya, *bhāva*, *prema* and *bhakti* reach their limit —*

মহাপ্রভুর ভক্তগণের দুর্গম মহিমা ।
তাহে রামানন্দের ভাবভক্তি-প্রেম-সীমা ॥ ২১ ॥

mahāprabhura bhakta-gaṇera durgama mahimā
of Mahāprabhu of the devotees unfathomable glory
tāhe rāmānandera bhāva-bhakti-prema-sīmā
among them Rāmānanda's of bhāva, bhakti and prema the limit

21 The glory of Mahāprabhu's devotees is unfathomable, and in Rāmānanda bhāva, bhakti and prema reach their utmost limit.

*To stage his play *Jagannātha-vallabha* before Śrī Jagannātha, Rāya teaches acting in the Jagannātha-vallabha garden —*

তবে সেই দুইজনে নৃত্য শিখাইলা ।
গীতের গূঢ় অর্থ অভিনয় করাইলা ॥ ২২ ॥

tabe sei dui-jane nṛtya śikhāilā
then those two dance he taught
gītera gūḍha artha abhinaya karāilā
of the songs hidden meaning acting he made them do

22 Then he taught the two to dance and had them act out the hidden meaning of the songs.

Anubhāṣya.
He taught how, through the actress (*naṭī*), to reveal well before the connoisseur of the transcendental *rasa* of Vraja the deep feelings contained in the songs of the play.

সঞ্চারী, সাত্ত্বিক, স্থায়ি-ভাবের লক্ষণ ।
মুখে-নেত্রে অভিনয় করে প্রকটন ॥ ২৩ ॥

sañcārī, sāttvika, sthāyi-bhāvera lakṣaṇa
transitory sāttvika of the abiding emotions the signs
mukhe-netre abhinaya kare prakaṭana
in face and eyes acting they make manifest

23 By acting with face and eyes, they brought out the signs of the transitory (*sañcārī*), the *sāttvika* and the abiding (*sthāyi*) feelings.

ভাবপ্রকটন-লাস্য রায় যে শিখায় ।
জগন্নাথের আগে দুঁহে প্রকট দেখায় ॥ ২৪ ॥

bhāva-prakaṭana-lāsya rāya ye śikhāya
bhāva-revealing graceful dance Rāya which teaches
jagannāthera āge duṁhe prakaṭa dekhāya
of Jagannātha before the two openly show

24 Rāya taught them the graceful feminine dance (*lāsya*) that reveals bhāva, and the two would display it openly before Jagannātha.

Anubhāṣya.
Bhāva-prakaṭana-lāsya: a woman's dance that reveals *bhāva*.

*After feeding the two *devadāsīs*, Rāya sends them home secretly, for the good of ignorant critics who see only with the senses —*

তবে সেই দুইজনে প্রসাদ খাওয়াইলা ।
নিভৃতে দুঁহারে নিজ-ঘরে পাঠাইলা ॥ ২৫ ॥

tabe sei dui-jane prasāda khāoyāilā
then those two prasāda he fed
nibhṛte duṁhāre nija-ghare pāṭhāilā
quietly both to their own home he sent

25 Then he gave the two prasāda to eat and quietly sent them home.

*The *mahā-bhāgavata* Rāya's service to his mistress in his perfected body is beyond the sense-born knowledge of living beings who follow the path of logic —*

প্রতিদিন রায় ঐছে করায় সাধন ।
কোন্ জানে ক্ষুদ্র জীব কাঁহা তাঁর মন ? ॥ ২৬ ॥

prati-dina rāya aiche karāya sādhana
every day Rāya thus makes them do practice
kon jāne kṣudra jīva kāṁhā tāṁra mana?
who knows petty living being where his mind

26 Every day Rāya trained them in this way. What petty soul can know where his mind dwells?

Anubhāṣya.
Every day he teaches the *devadāsīs* such transcendental acting. Petty people — worldly, absorbed in sense objects, busy gratifying the senses — cannot, with a mind that craves to enjoy insentient matter (*acit*), grasp the unearthly,

transcendental realm of Prabhu Rāmānanda's mind: that mind is made of pure goodness (*śuddha-sattva*) and is engaged in serving Kṛṣṇa.

*Hearing from his servant that Miśra has come, Rāya, who gives honor to others (*mānada*), comes to the assembly hall —*

মিশ্রের আগমন রায়ে সেবক কহিলা ।
শীঘ্র রামানন্দ তবে সভাতে আইলা ॥ ২৭ ॥

miśrera āgamana rāye sevaka kahilā
Miśra's arrival to Rāya the servant told
śīghra rāmānanda tabe sabhāte āilā
quickly Rāmānanda then to the hall came

27 The servant told Rāya that Miśra had come, and Rāmānanda at once came to the hall.

*Rāya, free of pride (*amānī*) and giving honor to others, greets Miśra fittingly and expresses his humility —*

মিশ্রেরে নমস্কার করে সম্মান করিয়া ।
নিবেদন করে কিছু বিনীত হঞা ॥ ২৮ ॥

miśrere namaskāra kare sammāna kariyā
to Miśra obeisance he makes respect showing
nivedana kare kichu vinīta hañā
submission he makes something humble becoming

28 Showing him respect, he bowed to Miśra and humbly said:

বহুক্ষণ আইলা, মোরে কেহ না কহিল ।
তোমার চরণে মোর অপরাধ হইল ॥ ২৯ ॥

bahu-kṣaṇa āilā, more keha nā kahila
long ago you came me anyone not told
tomāra caraṇe mora aparādha haila
at your feet my offense has been

29 “You have been here a long while, and no one told me. I have committed an offence at your feet.

তোমার আগমনে মোর পবিত্র হৈল ঘর ।
আজ্ঞা কর, ক্যা করোঁ তোমার কিঙ্কর ॥ ৩০ ॥

tomāra āgamane mora pavitra haila ghara
by your coming my pure became home
ājñā kara, kyā karoṁ tomāra kiṅkara
order do what shall I do your servant

30 Your coming has purified my home. Command me — what shall I, your servant, do?”

Miśra answers humbly —

মিশ্র কহে, — তোমা দেখিতে হৈল আগমনে ।
আপনা পবিত্র কৈলুঁ তোমার দরশনে ॥ ৩১ ॥

miśra kahe, — tomā dekhite haila āgamane
Miśra says you to see there was coming
āpanā pavitra kailuṁ tomāra daraśane
myself pure I made by your sight

31 Miśra said, “I came to see you, and by seeing you I have purified myself.”

Seeing that the time is unsuitable, Miśra returns home that day —

অতিকাল দেখি’ মিশ্র কিছু না কহিল ।
বিদায় হইয়া মিশ্র নিজঘর গেল ॥ ৩২ ॥

atikāla dekhi’ miśra kichu nā kahila
the late hour seeing Miśra anything not said
vidāya haiyā miśra nijaghara gela
leave taking Miśra to his home went

32 Seeing that it was too late, Miśra said nothing more; he took his leave and went home.

Anubhāṣya.

Atikāla: the time for conversation had passed; that is, if they began to talk at the wrong time, it would be inconvenient for both.

The next day the Lord asks Miśra whether he has heard about Kṛṣṇa from Rāya —

আর দিন মিশ্র আইল প্রভু-বিদ্যমানে ।
প্রভু কহে, — কৃষ্ণকথা শুনিলা রায়স্থানে ? ॥ ৩৩ ॥

āra dina miśra āila prabhu-vidyamāne
the next day Miśra came into the Lord's presence
prabhu kahe, — kṛṣṇa-kathā śunilā rāyasthāne?
the Lord says about Kṛṣṇa talks did you hear from Rāya

33 The next day Miśra came before the Lord, and the Lord asked, "Did you hear about Kṛṣṇa from Rāya?"

Miśra tells the Lord about Śrī Rāya —

তবে মিশ্র রামানন্দের বৃত্তান্ত কহিলা ।
শুনি' মহাপ্রভু তবে কহিতে লাগিলা ॥ ৩৪ ॥

tabe miśra rāmānandera vṛttānta kahilā
then Miśra Rāmānanda's doings told
śuni' mahāprabhu tabe kahite lāgilā
hearing Mahāprabhu then to speak began

34 Then Miśra told Him what Rāmānanda had been doing, and when Mahāprabhu heard it, He began to speak.

*Bhagavān, the model teacher of the *dharma* of freedom from pride, humbly*

glorifies His devotee's love for Kṛṣṇa as greater than His own —

আমি ত' সন্ন্যাসী, আপনারে বিরক্ত করি' মানি ।
দর্শন রহু দূরে, 'প্রকৃতি'র নাম যদি শুনি ॥ ৩৫ ॥

তবহিঁ বিকার পায় মোর তনু-মন ।
প্রকৃতি-দর্শনে স্থির হয় কোন্ জন ? ॥ ৩৬ ॥

āmi ta' sannyāsī, āpanāre virakta kari' māni
I indeed a sannyāsī Myself detached as I consider
darśana rahu dūre, 'prakṛti'ra nāma yadi śuni
seeing let it remain far of a woman the name if I hear
tabahiṁ vikāra pāya mora tanu-mana
even then agitation gets My body and mind
prakṛti-darśane sthira haya kon jana?
a woman on seeing steady is what person

35–36 "I am a sannyāsī and consider Myself detached; yet, to say nothing of seeing a woman, if I merely hear a woman's name, My body and mind are disturbed. Who can remain steady on seeing a woman?

Anubhāṣya.
Prakṛti: a *yoṣit*, that is, a woman, an object of enjoyment for a man.

*The character of Śrī Rāmānanda Gosvāmī — free from craving for sense pleasure and from any inclination to look at women, the detached crest-jewel of the *vidvat-sannyāsīs*, who sees Adhokṣaja, a *mahā-bhāgavata*, an *ātmārāma* —*

রামানন্দ-রায়ের কথা শুন, সর্ব্বজন ।
কহিবার নহে, যাহা আশ্চর্য্য-কথন ॥ ৩৭ ॥

rāmānanda-rāyera kathā śuna, sarva-jana
of Rāmānanda Rāya the account hear all people
kahibāra nahe, yāhā āścarya-kathana
to be told it is not which a wondrous account

37 Hear, all of you, about Rāmānanda Rāya — an account so wondrous that it can hardly be told.

একে দেবদাসী, আর সুন্দরী তরুণী ।
তাহাদের সব সেবা করেন আপনি ॥ ৩৮ ॥

eke deva-dāsī, āra sundarī taruṇī
first devadāsīs and beautiful young women
tāhādera saba sevā karena āpani
for them all service he does himself

38 First, they are *devadāsīs*, maidservants of the Deity, and moreover they are beautiful young women; yet he himself performs every service for them.[1]

Anubhāṣya.
Saba sevā: every kind of service (see verse 39).

স্নানাদি করায়, পরায় বাস-বিভূষণ ।
গুহ্য অঙ্গ যত, তার দর্শন-স্পর্শন ॥ ৩৯ ॥

snānādi karāya, parāya vāsa-vibhūṣaṇa
bathing and so on he has them do he puts on clothes and ornaments
guhya aṅga yata, tāra darśana-sparśana
private parts all of them seeing and touching

39 He bathes them and dresses them in clothes and ornaments, and he sees and touches all the hidden parts of their bodies.

তবু নির্ব্বিকার রায়-রামানন্দের মন ।
নানাভাবোদ্গম তারে করায় শিক্ষণ ॥ ৪০ ॥

tabu nirvikāra rāya-rāmānandera mana
yet unmoved of Rāya Rāmānanda the mind
nānābhāvodgama tāre karāya śikṣaṇa
the rising of various bhāvas them he makes learn

40 Yet the mind of Rāya Rāmānanda remains unmoved as he teaches them to express the stirrings of many different bhāvas.

Anubhāṣya.

Nānābhāvodgama: the display of the thirty-three kinds of *bhāva* needed to enact Kṛṣṇa's pastimes.

নির্ব্বিকার দেহ-মন — কাষ্ঠ-পাষাণ সম !
আশ্চর্য্য, — তরুণী-স্পর্শে নির্ব্বিকার মন ! ॥ ৪১ ॥

nirvikāra deha-mana — kāṣṭha-pāṣāṇa sama!
unmoved body and mind wood and stone like
āścarya, — taruṇī-sparśe nirvikāra mana!
wonderful a young woman at touching unmoved mind

41 His body and mind are unmoved, like wood or stone. How wonderful — at the touch of a young woman his mind is unmoved!

Anubhāṣya.

Dry wood is insentient and does not grow; hard stone does not melt. Just so, Rāmānanda's body and mind underwent no change.

*From the effect one infers the cause: a spiritual entity made of pure goodness (*śuddha-sattva*) is beyond the *guṇas* and untouched by the worldly *guṇas*; therefore Rāmānanda has a transcendental body of spirit and bliss —*

এক রামানন্দের হয় এই অধিকার ।
তাতে জানি অপ্রাকৃত-দেহ তাঁহার ॥ ৪২ ॥

eka rāmānandera haya ei adhikāra
alone of Rāmānanda is this qualification
tāte jāni aprākṛta-deha tāṁhāra
from that I know transcendental body his

42 Rāmānanda alone has this qualification; from it I know that his body is transcendental.

*The workings of a devotee's heart are beyond the senses (*adhokṣaja*); they transcend sense-born knowledge —*

তাঁহার মনের ভাব তেঁহ জানে মাত্র ।
তাহা জানিবারে আর দ্বিতীয় নাহি পাত্র ॥ ৪৩ ॥

tāṁhāra manera bhāva teṁha jāne mātra
his mind's state he knows only
tāhā jānibāre āra dvitīya nāhi pātra
that to know other second there is not fit person

43 Only he knows the state of his mind; there is no one else fit to know it.

*Inference has meaning only when it follows the *Śrī Bhāgavatam*, the spotless evidence of the word (*śabda-pramāṇa*); the conclusion that shows the cause of the transcendental workings of Śrī Rāya's heart —*

কিন্তু শাস্ত্রদৃষ্ট্যে করি এক অনুমান ।
শ্রীভাগবত-শাস্ত্র — তাহাতে প্রমাণ ॥ ৪৪ ॥

kintu śāstra-dṛṣṭye kari eka anumāna
but in the light of scripture I make one inference
śrī-bhāgavata-śāstra — tāhāte pramāṇa
the Śrī Bhāgavata scripture of that the evidence

44 But in the light of scripture I draw one inference. The *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* bears witness to this.[2]

*One who follows *rāgānugā-bhakti* with transcendental faith attains perfection (*siddhi*), that is, becomes a *gosvāmī*, by hearing and chanting Kṛṣṇa's pastimes —*

ব্রজবধূ-সঙ্গে কৃষ্ণের রাসাদি-বিলাস ।
যেই জন কহে, শুনে করিয়া বিশ্বাস ॥ ৪৫ ॥

হৃদ্রোগ-কাম তাঁর তৎকালে হয় ক্ষয় ।
তিনগুণ-ক্ষোভ নহে, 'মহাধীর' হয় ॥ ৪৬ ॥

vraja-vadhū-saṅge kṛṣṇera rāsādi-vilāsa
with the young women of Vraja Kṛṣṇa's the rāsa and other pastimes
yei jana kahe, śune kariyā viśvāsa
which person tells hears having faith
hṛd-roga-kāma tāṁra tat-kāle haya kṣaya
the heart's disease, lust his at once is destroyed
tina-guṇa-kṣobha nahe, 'mahā-dhīra' haya
of the three guṇas agitation is not very steady he becomes

45–46 When a person, with faith, hears and tells of Kṛṣṇa's rāsa dance and His other pastimes with the young women of Vraja, his lust, the disease of the heart, is destroyed at once. The three guṇas no longer agitate him, and he becomes perfectly steady (*mahā-dhīra*).

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Tina guṇa (the three *guṇas*): *sattva*, *rajas* and *tamas*. The agitation of these three *guṇas* gives rise to the desire for union between man and woman, but in him no such desire arises.

Anubhāṣya.

Whoever, with faith and with a transcendental heart, describes or hears Kṛṣṇa's transcendental sweet pastimes — the *rāsa* and the rest — as the *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* describes them, his worldly lust born of the mind (*manasija*) is completely destroyed. The speaker or hearer of Kṛṣṇa's transcendental pastimes feels his own existence in the transcendental realm, and so the three *guṇas* of nature cannot overcome him. Toward matter he is wholly beyond the *guṇas* (*nirguṇa*): his mind is unshakable, and he is able to understand his own qualification (*nija-adhikāra*) for serving Kṛṣṇa.

Let no one, like the *prākṛta-sahajiyās*, think in this connection: "A *jīva* greedy for worldly lust need not gain knowledge of *sambandha*. Keeping a worldly mind, he may live in his own realm of enjoyment, give up *sādhana-bhakti*, and regard Kṛṣṇa's transcendental play, His pastimes — the *rāsa* and the rest — as a model of worldly enjoyment like his own. If he simply hears and chants about them, his material lust will be destroyed." It is precisely to forbid this that Mahāprabhu, by the word *viśvāsa* (faith), dispelled the worldly mentality of the *prākṛta-sahajiyās*. Śrī Śuka also said: "One who is not a controller (*anīśvara*) must never do this, even in his mind. Whoever does it out of folly perishes, as one

who is not Rudra would perish by drinking the poison born of the ocean." (*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 10.33.30)

Hearing and chanting Kṛṣṇa's pastimes swells the ocean of the bliss of love for Kṛṣṇa —

উজ্জ্বল মধুর-রস প্রেমভক্তি পায় ।
আনন্দে কৃষ্ণমাধুর্য্যে বিহরে সদায় ॥ ৪৭ ॥

ujjvala madhura-rasa prema-bhakti pāya
radiant of madhura-rasa prema-bhakti he attains
ānande kṛṣṇa-mādhurye vihare sadāya
in bliss in Kṛṣṇa's sweetness he sports always

47 He attains prema-bhakti in the radiant *madhura-rasa*, and in bliss he ever revels in Kṛṣṇa's sweetness.

*The evidence of the scripture *Bhāgavatam* — (*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 10.33.39)*

বিক্রীড়িতং ব্রজবধূভিরিদঞ্চ বিষ্ণোঃ
শ্রদ্ধান্বিতোঽনুশৃণুয়াদথ বর্ণয়েদ্ যঃ ।
ভক্তিং পরাং ভগবতি প্রতিলভ্য কামং
হৃদ্রোগমাশ্বপহিনোত্যচিরেণ ধীরঃ ॥ ৪৮ ॥

vikrīḍitaṁ vraja-vadhūbhir idaṁ ca viṣṇoḥ
the play with the young women of Vraja this and of Viṣṇu
śraddhānvito 'nuśṛṇuyād atha varṇayed yaḥ
endowed with faith constantly hears then describes who
bhaktiṁ parāṁ bhagavati pratilabhya kāmaṁ
devotion supreme for the Lord having attained lust
hṛd-rogam āśv apahinoty acireṇa dhīraḥ
the heart's disease quickly casts off soon steadfast

48 "The steadfast soul who, endowed with faith, constantly hears of this play of Viṣṇu with the young women of Vraja and then describes it, soon

attains supreme devotion to the Lord and quickly casts off lust, the disease of the heart." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 10.33.39)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Whoever, filled with transcendental faith, hears or describes Kṛṣṇa's transcendental play with the young women of Vraja in these "Five Chapters on the Rāsa" (*rāsa-pañcādhyāyī*) — that steady person (*dhīra*) gains abundant supreme devotion (*parā-bhakti*) for Bhagavān and quickly drives away material lust, the disease of the heart. The point is this: all of Kṛṣṇa's pastimes are "spiritual" (*cinmaya*). The fully spiritual Kṛṣṇa, beyond the senses (*adhokṣaja*), plays with the spiritual gopīs. When one discusses these pastimes with faith, that is, striving to realize the spiritual truth, then, as spiritual love awakens, attachment to matter, material lust and the rest depart. And when the wholly spiritual pastimes have fully appeared, not a trace of material lust remains.

Anubhāṣya.

yaḥ pumān (a person) **śraddhānvitaḥ** (endowed with faith, that is, with a transcendental firm conviction; eager to serve) **vraja-vadhūbhiḥ** (with the gopīs) **viṣṇoḥ** (of the son of Nanda, the supreme Lord) **idam** (described earlier, in the "Five Chapters on the Rāsa") **ca vikrīḍitam** (the special play called the *rāsa*) **anuśṛṇuyāt** (*anu*, constantly; let him hear from the lips of the guru, with no worldly barrier) **atha** (then) **varṇayet** (by the path of the *rūpānugas*, step by step, performs *saṅkīrtana* of Kṛṣṇa's name, form, qualities, pastimes and so on), **saḥ dhīraḥ** (the unshakable *rāgānuga gosvāmī*, who has conquered the six urges) **acireṇa bhagavati** (for Kṛṣṇa) **parāṁ bhaktim** (the highest *prema-bhakti*) **pratilabhya** (having attained) **hṛd-rogam** (the affliction of the mind, lust born of the mind) **āśu** (quickly) **apahinoti** (drives away).

*By constantly cultivating Kṛṣṇa's pastimes, the *rāgānuga* devotee attains perfection in his own true nature (*svarūpa-siddhi*) and a body of spirit and bliss —*

যে শুনে, যে পড়ে, তাঁর ফল এতাদৃশী ।
সেই ভাবাবিষ্ট, যেই সেবে অহর্নিশি ॥ ৪৯ ॥

ye śune, ye paḍe, tāṁra phala etādṛśī
who hears who reads his fruit is such
sei bhāvāviṣṭa, yei seve ahar-niśi
he absorbed in bhāva who serves day and night

49 Such is the fruit for whoever hears or reads of these pastimes. But as for one who, absorbed in bhāva, serves day and night —

তাঁর ফল কি কহিমু, কহনে না যায় ৷
নিত্যসিদ্ধ সেই, প্রায়-সিদ্ধ তাঁর কায় ॥ ৫০ ॥

tāṁra phala ki kahimu, kahane nā yāya
his fruit what shall I tell in words not it goes
nitya-siddha sei, prāya-siddha tāṁra kāya
eternally perfect he almost perfect his body

50 what can I say of his fruit? It cannot be put into words. He is eternally perfect (*nitya-siddha*), and his body is almost perfect (*prāya-siddha*).

Anubhāṣya.
Whoever hears of and chants Śrī Kṛṣṇa's transcendental play — the *rāsa* and the rest — and, following Śrī Rūpa's transcendental mood, constantly serves Kṛṣṇa in his mind, absorbed in pure, unfeigned *rāga*, attains a matchless fruit that worldly language cannot describe. He is an eternally perfect associate (*nitya-siddha pārṣada*). Or else his body is almost perfect (*siddha-prāya*)[0]: though it is visible to people's eyes, in it, as he attains *svarūpa-siddhi*, dwell the feelings devoted to Kṛṣṇa's service, and so all his activities are transcendental. Until, by Kṛṣṇa's will, he attains *vastu-siddhi*, his body is almost perfect and transcendental.

*Śrī Rāya, eternally perfect (*nitya-siddha*), follows *rāgātmikā-bhakti* —*

রাগানুগ-মার্গে জানি রায়ের ভজন ৷
সিদ্ধদেহ-তুল্য, তাতে ‘প্রাকৃত’ নহে মন ॥ ৫১ ॥

rāgānuga-mārge jāni rāyera bhajana
on the rāgānuga path I know Rāya’s worship
siddha-deha-tulya, tāte ‘prākṛta’ nahe mana
to a perfected body equal therefore mundane is not the mind

51 I know that Rāya's worship follows the path of rāgānuga. His body is like a perfected spiritual body (*siddha-deha*), and so his mind is not mundane.

The mark of a guru is knowledge of the truth about Kṛṣṇa, wholly directed to pleasing Kṛṣṇa's senses, not nobility of seed and the like —

আমিহ রায়ের স্থানে শুনি কৃষ্ণকথা ।
শুনিতে ইচ্ছা হয় যদি, পুনঃ যাহ' তথা ॥ ৫২ ॥

āmiha rāyera sthāne śuni kṛṣṇa-kathā
I too Rāya's at the place hear talks about Kṛṣṇa
śunite icchā haya yadi, punaḥ yāha' tathā
to hear desire is if again go there

52 I too hear about Kṛṣṇa from Rāya. If you wish to hear, go there again.

The Lord sends Miśra again to Rāya to become his disciple —

মোর নামে কহিহ, — তেঁহো পাঠাইলা মোরে ।
তোমার স্থানে কৃষ্ণকথা শুনিবার তরে ॥ ৫৩ ॥

mora nāme kahiha, — teṁho pāṭhāilā more
in My name say He sent me
tomāra sthāne kṛṣṇa-kathā śunibāra tare
your at the place talks about Kṛṣṇa to hear in order

53 Tell him in My name: 'He has sent me to hear about Kṛṣṇa from you.'

শীঘ্র যাহ', যাবৎ তেঁহো আছেন সভাতে ।
এত শুনি' প্রদ্যুম্ন-মিশ্র চলিলা ত্বরিতে ॥ ৫৪ ॥

śīghra yāha', yāvat teṁho āchena sabhāte
quickly go while he is in the hall
eta śuni' pradyumna-miśra calilā tvarite
this hearing Pradyumna Miśra went in haste

54 Go quickly, while he is still in the hall.” Hearing this, Pradyumna Miśra set off in haste.

Miśra goes to Rāya's house; Rāya, free of pride and giving honor to others, greets Miśra —

রায়-পাশ গেল, রায় প্রণতি করিল ।
আজ্ঞা কর, যে লাগি’ আগমন হৈল ॥ ৫৫ ॥

rāya-pāśa gela, rāya praṇati karila
to Rāya he went Rāya obeisance made
ājñā kara, ye lāgi’ āgamana haila
order do what for coming has been

55 He went to Rāya, and Rāya bowed to him and said, “Command me; tell me why you have come.”

Miśra says that the Lord has sent him —

মিশ্র কহে, — মহাপ্রভু পাঠাইলা মোরে ।
তোমার স্থানে কৃষ্ণকথা শুনিবার তরে ॥ ৫৬ ॥

miśra kahe, — mahāprabhu pāṭhāilā more
Miśra says Mahāprabhu sent me
tomāra sthāne kṛṣṇa-kathā śunibāra tare
your at the place talks about Kṛṣṇa to hear in order

56 Miśra said, “Mahāprabhu has sent me to hear about Kṛṣṇa from you.”

Rāya's joy —

শুনি’ রামানন্দ মনে হইলা সন্তোষে ।
কহিতে লাগিলা কিছু মনের হরিষে ॥ ৫৭ ॥

śuni’ rāmānanda mane hailā santoṣe
hearing Rāmānanda in mind became pleased
kahite lāgilā kichu manera hariṣe
to speak began something of the mind in joy

57 Hearing this, Rāmānanda was pleased, and with joy in his heart he began to speak:

Hearing the Lord's order, Rāya speaks of his good fortune —

প্রভুর আজ্ঞায় কৃষ্ণকথা শুনিতে আইলা এথা ।
ইহা বই মহাভাগ্য আমি পাব কোথা ? ॥ ৫৮ ॥

prabhura ājñāya kṛṣṇa-kathā śunite āilā ethā
of the Lord by the order talks about Kṛṣṇa to hear you came here
ihā vai mahābhāgya āmi pāba kothā?
this besides great fortune I shall find where

58 "By the Lord's order you have come here to hear about Kṛṣṇa. Where else could I find such great fortune?"

In private Rāya asks Miśra —

এত কহি' তারে লঞা নিভৃতে বসিলা ।
কি কথা শুনিতে চাহ? মিশ্রেরে পুছিলা ॥ ৫৯ ॥

eta kahi' tāre lañā nibhṛte vasilā
this saying him taking in seclusion he sat
ki kathā śunite cāha? miśrere puchilā
what topic to hear do you want Miśra he asked

59 Saying this, he took him to a secluded place, sat down with him and asked Miśra, "What would you like to hear?"

*Miśra asks Rāya to speak again about Kṛṣṇa — of *sambandha*, *abhidheya* and *prayojana* — as Rāya had spoken before with the Lord —*

তেঁহো কহে, — যে কহিলা বিদ্যানগরে ।
সেই কথা ক্রমে তুমি কহিবা আমারে ॥ ৬০ ॥

teṁho kahe, — ye kahilā vidyānagare
he says what you told in Vidyānagara
sei kathā krame tumi kahibā āmāre
those topics in order you please tell me

60 He said, “Please tell me, in order, all that you spoke of in Vidyānagara.

Miśra's humble words —

আনের কি কথা, তুমি — প্রভুর উপদেষ্টা !
আমি ত’ ভিক্ষুক বিপ্র, তুমি — মোর পোষ্টা ॥ ৬১ ॥

ānera ki kathā, tumi — prabhura upadeṣṭā!
of others what talk you of the Lord the instructor
āmi ta’ bhikṣuka vipra, tumi — mora poṣṭā
I indeed a mendicant brāhmaṇa you my sustainer

61 You are the instructor not only of others but of the Lord Himself! I am a poor mendicant brāhmaṇa, and you are my sustainer.

ভাল, মন্দ — কিছু আমি পুছিতে না জানি ৷
‘দীন’ দেখি’ কৃপা করি’ কহিবা আপনি ॥ ৬২ ॥

bhāla, manda — kichu āmi puchite nā jāni
good bad anything I to ask not know
‘dīna’ dekhi’ kṛpā kari’ kahibā āpani
wretched seeing mercy showing please tell yourself

62 I do not know how to ask anything, good or bad. Seeing how wretched I am, be merciful and tell me of your own accord.”

Śrī Rāmānanda speaks about Kṛṣṇa —

তবে রামানন্দ ক্রমে কহিতে লাগিলা ৷
কৃষ্ণকথা-রসামৃত-সিন্ধু উথলিলা ॥ ৬৩ ॥

tabe rāmānanda krame kahite lāgilā
then Rāmānanda in order to speak began
kṛṣṇa-kathā-rasāmṛta-sindhu uthalilā
the ocean of the nectar of rasa in talks about Kṛṣṇa surged

63 Then Rāmānanda began to speak of Kṛṣṇa in due order, and in his words the nectar-ocean of rasa surged up.

*Understanding the disciple's level (*adhikāra*), Rāya himself asks the questions and himself answers them —*

আপনে প্রশ্ন করি' পাছে করেন সিদ্ধান্ত ।
তৃতীয় প্রহর হৈল, নহে কথা-অন্ত ॥ ৬৪ ॥

āpane praśna kari' pāche karena siddhānta
himself question raising afterward he makes conclusion
tṛtīya prahara haila, nahe kathā-anta
the third prahara came there is not of the talk end

64 He himself raised the questions and then gave the conclusive answers (*siddhānta*). The third watch (*prahara*) of the day came, and still the talk did not end.

Both forget themselves in talk about Kṛṣṇa —

বক্তা শ্রোতা কহে শুনে দুঁহে প্রেমাবেশে ।
আত্মস্মৃতি নাহি, কাঁহা জানে দিন শেষে ॥ ৬৫ ॥

vaktā śrotā kahe śune duṁhe premāveśe
the speaker the listener speaks hears both in the absorption of prema
ātmasmṛti nāhi, kāṁhā jāne dina śeṣe
self-awareness there is not how they know of the day the end

65 Speaker and listener, one speaking and the other hearing, were both absorbed in prema. They had no awareness of themselves — how could they know the day had ended?

The day passes in talk about Kṛṣṇa —

সেবক কহিল, — ‘দিন হৈল অবসান’ ।
তবে রায় কৃষ্ণকথার করিলা বিশ্রাম ॥ ৬৬ ॥

sevaka kahila, — ‘dina haila avasāna’
the servant said the day has come to an end
tabe rāya kṛṣṇakathāra karilā viśrāma
then Rāya to the talk about Kṛṣṇa made a pause

66 When the servant said, “The day is over,” Rāya brought his talk of Kṛṣṇa to a close.

Rāya bids Miśra farewell; Miśra's joy —

বহুসম্মান করি’ মিশ্রে বিদায় দিলা ।
কৃতার্থ হইলাঙ বলি’ মিশ্র নাচিতে লাগিলা ॥ ৬৭ ॥

bahu-sammāna kari’ miśre vidāya dilā
great respect showing to Miśra leave he gave
kṛtārtha hailāṅa bali’ miśra nācite lāgilā
fulfilled I have become saying Miśra to dance began

67 With great respect he bade Miśra farewell, and Miśra, crying, “My life is fulfilled!” began to dance.

In the evening Miśra comes to the Lord —

ঘরে গিয়া মিশ্র কৈল স্নান, ভোজন ।
সন্ধ্যাকালে দেখিতে আইল প্রভুর চরণ ॥ ৬৮ ॥

ghare giyā miśra kaila snāna, bhojana
home going Miśra did bathing eating
sandhyākāle dekhite āila prabhura caraṇa
in the evening to see he came of the Lord the feet

68 Miśra went home, bathed and took his meal, and in the evening he came to see the Lord.

The Lord asks Miśra whether he has heard about Kṛṣṇa —

প্রভুর চরণ বন্দে উল্লসিত-মনে ।
প্রভু কহে, — কৃষ্ণকথা হইল শ্রবণে ? ॥ ৬৯ ॥

prabhura caraṇa vande ullasita-mane
the Lord's feet he worships with a joyful mind
prabhu kahe, — kṛṣṇa-kathā haila śravaṇe?
the Lord says talks about Kṛṣṇa was there hearing

69 With a joyful heart he bowed at the Lord's feet, and the Lord asked, "Did you hear about Kṛṣṇa?"

Miśra says that his life's purpose is fulfilled —

মিশ্র কহে, — প্রভু, মোরে কৃতার্থ করিলা ।
কৃষ্ণকথামৃতার্ণবে মোরে ডুবাইলা ॥ ৭০ ॥

miśra kahe, — prabhu, more kṛtārtha karilā
Miśra says O Lord me fulfilled You have made
kṛṣṇa-kathāmṛtārṇave more ḍubāilā
in the ocean of the nectar of talks about Kṛṣṇa me You have plunged

70 Miśra said, "O Lord, You have fulfilled my life! You have plunged me into the nectar-ocean of talks about Kṛṣṇa.

It is forbidden to regard as mortal the guru who sings of Kṛṣṇa —

রামানন্দ-রায়-কথা কহিলে না হয় ।
'মনুষ্য' নহে রায়, কৃষ্ণভক্তিরসময় ॥ ৭১ ॥

rāmānanda-rāya-kathā kahile nā haya
of Rāmānanda Rāya the words if told not it is possible
'manuṣya' nahe rāya, kṛṣṇa-bhakti-rasa-maya
a human being is not Rāya made of the rasa of devotion to Kṛṣṇa

71 The words of Rāmānanda Rāya cannot be retold. Rāya is not a mere human being; he is made of the rasa of devotion to Kṛṣṇa.

Through the lips of Śrī Rāmānanda, the guru, Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya Mahāprabhu is the speaker —

আর এক কথা রায় কহিলা আমারে ।
'কৃষ্ণকথা-বক্তা করি' না জানিহ মোরে ॥ ৭২ ॥

āra eka kathā rāya kahilā āmāre
another one thing Rāya told me
'kṛṣṇa-kathā-vaktā kari' nā jāniha more
of talks about Kṛṣṇa the speaker as not consider me

72 Rāya told me one thing more: 'Do not think of me as the speaker of these talks about Kṛṣṇa.

মোর মুখে কথা কহেন আপনে গৌরচন্দ্র ।
যৈছে কহায়, তৈছে কহি, — যেন বীণাযন্ত্র ॥ ৭৩ ॥

mora mukhe kathā kahena āpane gauracandra
by my mouth words speaks Himself Gauracandra
yaiche kahāya, taiche kahi, — yena vīṇā-yantra
as He makes me speak so I speak like a vīṇā instrument

73 Gauracandra Himself speaks these words through my mouth. As He makes me speak, so I speak, like a *vīṇā*.

Through the lips of Rāmānanda, a worthy vessel, the Lord preaches about Kṛṣṇa —

মোর মুখে কথা ইঁহা করে পরচার ।
পৃথিবীতে কে জানিবে এ-লীলা তাঁহার ? ॥ ৭৪ ॥

mora mukhe kathā iṁhā kare paracāra
by my mouth the words He makes known
pṛthivīte ke jānibe e-līlā tāṁhāra?
in the world who will know this pastime His

74 Through my mouth He makes these words known. Who in this world will understand this pastime of His?'

The talks about Kṛṣṇa that Rāya spoke and Miśra heard are beyond the reach even of Brahmā —

যে-সব শুনিলুঁ, কৃষ্ণ — রসের সাগর ।
ব্রহ্মাদি-দেবের এ সব না হয় গোচর ॥ ৭৫ ॥

ye-saba śunilum̐, kṛṣṇa — rasera sāgara
all that I heard Kṛṣṇa of rasa the ocean
brahmādi-devera e saba nā haya gocara
to Brahmā and the other gods this all not is perceptible

75 All that I heard — that Kṛṣṇa is the ocean of rasa — lies beyond the reach even of Brahmā and the other gods.

Miśra offers himself at the Lord's feet —

হেন 'রস' মোরে পান করাইলা তুমি ।
জন্মে জন্মে তোমার পায় বিকাইলাঙ আমি ॥ ৭৬ ॥

hena 'rasa' more pāna karāilā tumi
such rasa me to drink made You
janme janme tomāra pāya vikāilāṅa āmi
birth after birth Your at the feet sold myself I

76 You have made me drink such rasa; birth after birth I have sold myself at Your feet."

The Lord describes the nature of the pure Vaiṣṇava who follows Rāya's example —

প্রভু কহে, — রামানন্দ বিনয়ের খনি ।
আপনার কথা পরমুণ্ডে দেন আনি ॥ ৭৭ ॥

prabhu kahe, — rāmānanda vinayera khani
the Lord says Rāmānanda of humility a mine
āpanāra kathā para-muṇḍe dena āni
his own words on another's head he places bringing

77 The Lord said, “Rāmānanda is a mine of humility. He attributes his own words to another.

*The nature of a *sādhu*, a noble person, a great soul, that is, a Vaiṣṇava —*

মহানুভবের এই সহজ ‘স্বভাব’ হয় ।
আপনার গুণ নাহি আপনে কহয় ॥ ৭৮ ॥

mahānubhavera ei sahaja ‘svabhāva’ haya
of great souls this natural disposition is
āpanāra guṇa nāhi āpane kahaya
their own qualities not themselves they tell

78 This is the natural disposition of great souls: they never speak of their own qualities.”

*Miśra is the hearing disciple of Śrī Rāya, who sings of Kṛṣṇa and is the guru of all *brāhmaṇa* families, though not born in a family of *brāhmaṇas* by seed —*

রামানন্দ-রায়ের এই কহিলুঁ গুণ-লেশ ।
প্রদ্যুম্ন-মিশ্রেরে যৈছে কৈলা উপদেশ ॥ ৭৯ ॥

rāmānanda-rāyera ei kahiluṁ guṇa-leśa
of Rāmānanda Rāya this I have told of qualities a trace
pradyumna-miśrere yaiche kailā upadeśa
to Pradyumna Miśra how he gave instruction

79 Thus I have told a little of Rāmānanda Rāya’s qualities and of how he instructed Pradyumna Miśra.

*What Rāya's great qualities teach: outward conduct according to *varṇāśrama* is no sign of devotion to Kṛṣṇa or of being a guru —*

‘গৃহস্থ’ হঞা নহে রায় ষড়্-বর্গের বশে ।
‘বিষয়ী’ হঞা সন্ন্যাসীরে উপদেশে ॥ ৮০ ॥

'gṛhastha' hañā nahe rāya ṣaḍ-vargera vaśe
a householder being not Rāya of the six enemies under the control
'viṣayī' hañā sannyāsīre upadeśe
a worldly man being sannyāsīs he instructs

80 Though a householder, Rāya is not under the control of the six enemies (*ṣaḍ-varga*); though seemingly a worldly man (*viṣayī*), he instructs sannyāsīs.

Anubhāṣya.

In the eyes of worldly people Śrī Rāmānanda Prabhu appears to be a householder on the path of *pravṛtti* (worldly engagement), not a *brahmacārī* with controlled senses, a *vānaprastha* or a *bhikṣu*. Worldly householders, ruled by their senses, take up the *dharma* of those attached to home (*gṛhavrata*). But a transcendental Vaiṣṇava living at home does not, like a non-Vaiṣṇava householder, become one whose senses are uncontrolled (*adānta-go*), and he never falls under the power of the six enemies (*ṣaḍ-varga*). In Śrī Rāmānanda Prabhu's pastimes in the householder *āśrama*, worldly people, with their enjoying vision, see him as a *viṣayī*, one absorbed in worldly objects. But his transcendental mind of pure goodness worships at every moment a single object, the transcendental pastimes of Śrī Kṛṣṇa. He is therefore a *kṛṣṇa-viṣayī*, one whose object is Kṛṣṇa, and not an impersonalist logician hostile to Bhagavān's spiritual pastimes. He is able to make *sannyāsīs* who have renounced worldly objects and stand beyond the *guṇas* (*nirguṇa*) give up petty material objects that hold no realization of Kṛṣṇa, and to engage them in constantly cultivating Kṛṣṇa as their only object.

Through Rāya the Lord shows the glory of a devotee of Kṛṣṇa, that is, of the guru —

এইসব গুণ তাঁর প্রকাশ করিতে ।
মিশ্রেরে পাঠাইলা তাঁহা শ্রবণ করিতে ॥ ৮১ ॥

eisaba guṇa tāṁra prakāśa karite
all these qualities his manifest to make
miśrere pāṭhāilā tāṁhā śravaṇa karite
Miśra He sent there hearing to do

81 To reveal all these qualities of his, the Lord sent Miśra there to hear.

ভক্তগুণ প্রকাশিতে প্রভু ভাল জানে ।
নানা-ভঙ্গীতে প্রকাশি' নিজ লাভ মানে ॥ ৮২ ॥

bhakta-guṇa prakāśite prabhu bhāla jāne
the devotee's qualities to reveal the Lord well knows
nānā-bhaṅgīte prakāśi' nija lābha māne
in various ways revealing His own gain He considers

82 The Lord knows well how to reveal the qualities of His devotees; revealing them in various ways, He considers it His own gain.

Anubhāṣya.
Bhaṅgī: manner, skillful device, example.

The secret of how Gaura, the guru of the world, teaches people —

আর এক 'স্বভাব' গৌরের শুন, ভক্তগণ ।
গূঢ় ঐশ্বর্য্য-স্বভাব করে প্রকটন ॥ ৮৩ ॥

āra eka 'svabhāva' gaurera śuna, bhakta-gaṇa
another one 'trait' of Gaura hear O devotees
gūḍha aiśvarya-svabhāva kare prakaṭana
hidden majestic nature He makes manifest

83 Hear, O devotees, of yet another trait of Gaura: He makes His hidden, majestic nature manifest.

Anubhāṣya.
Gūḍha: hidden within, unmanifest; **aiśvarya-svabhāva**: the power of the Lord (*aiśī-śakti*), the might of Īśvara.

*Worldly *varṇāśrama*, learning and the like are no sign of one who can speak the true *dharma* —*

সন্ন্যাসী-পণ্ডিতগণের করিতে গর্ব্ব নাশ ।
নীচ-শূদ্র-দ্বারা করেন ধর্ম্মের প্রকাশ ॥ ৮৪ ॥

sannyāsī-paṇḍita-gaṇera karite garva nāśa
of the sannyāsīs and paṇḍitas to make of the pride destruction
nīca-śūdra-dvārā karena dharmera prakāśa
through a lowly śūdra He makes of dharma the manifestation

84 To destroy the pride of the sannyāsīs and paṇḍitas, He reveals dharma through a lowly śūdra.

Anubhāṣya.

Paṇḍita: a *brāhmaṇa* entitled to study the Vedas; **sannyāsī**: the highest of the four *āśramas* of a *brāhmaṇa*. According to worldly ideas, only *brāhmaṇas* by seed have the right to Sāvitrī initiation. Birth through Sāvitrī initiation gives the right to study the Vedas, and having gained *brāhmaṇa* birth through Sāvitrī and passed through three *āśramas*, one rises to the high position of a *sannyāsī*. The *brāhmaṇa* is the guru of the three *varṇas*, and the *sannyāsī* is the guru of the *brāhmaṇas* in the other three *āśramas*. Wishing to humble their worldly pride, born of intoxication with their position, the Lord had Śrī Rāmānanda Rāya Prabhu instruct a *brāhmaṇa* by seed named Pradyumna Miśra, although worldly vision knew Rāmānanda as a *śūdra*, the lowest *varṇa*, and as a householder, the lowest *āśrama*. And Mahāprabhu Himself, who had accepted *sannyāsa*, accepted the *dharma* that Śrī Rāmānanda preached.

Śrī Gaurahari wished to reveal to people the essential conclusion of the scriptures about the *āśramas*. So He spread the force of His natural majesty (*aiśvarya*) against the mistaken notions of those who think themselves worldly scholars and renunciants. Ordinary ignorant people do not know the purport of the scriptures; but seeing the pure, righteous conduct and the qualities of the servants who had taken shelter of Gaurasundara, they could understand the true purport of the scriptures about *varṇa* and *āśrama*. A transcendental Vaiṣṇava wholly devoted to Hari, in whatever family he has appeared and in whatever *āśrama* he lives, can be the highest *ācārya* of the true *dharma* — a guru who eternally shows mercy to worldly people of the four *varṇas* and *āśramas*. The scriptures say this again and again. Bhagavān Gaurahari indisputably preached to people the hidden and true aim of the scriptures, and so revealed His natural majesty (*aiśvarya-svabhāva*).

*Examples. (1) The Lord Himself, in the dress of a *sannyāsī*, and Miśra, a *brāhmaṇa* by seed, both become disciples eager to hear and accept as their*

*guru Śrī Rāya — who wears a householder's dress, was not born in a family of *brāhmaṇas* by seed, and sings of Kṛṣṇa — and so they teach the people —*

‘ভক্তি’, ‘প্রেম’, ‘তত্ত্ব’ কহে রায়ে করি’ ‘বক্তা’ ।
আপনি প্রদ্যুম্নমিশ্র-সহ হয় ‘শ্রোতা’ ॥ ৮৫ ॥

‘bhakti’, ‘prema’, ‘tattva’ kahe rāye kari’ ‘vaktā’
‘bhakti’ ‘prema’ ‘tattva’ He speaks Rāya making ‘the speaker’
āpani pradyumna-miśra-saha haya ‘śrotā’
Himself with Pradyumna Miśra becomes ‘the listener’

85 He speaks of bhakti, prema and the truth (*tattva*), making Rāya the speaker, while He Himself, together with Pradyumna Miśra, becomes the listener.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

The *sannyāsīs* (of Śaṅkara's school) think that, having carried out in worldly life all the duties proper to a *brāhmaṇa* and having cultivated the truth of Vedānta, they have become the “gurus” of the world. The *brāhmaṇa* scholars (by seed) think that, according to the *smṛti* (of the section on ritual work, the *karma-kāṇḍa*), only a *brāhmaṇa* by seed like themselves is the guru of all *varṇas*; therefore no one but such a *brāhmaṇa* scholar by seed has the right to teach the highest truth. Proud with these two kinds of pride, the *sannyāsīs* and scholars are unwilling to learn *dharma* from a pure devotee born in a family of the highest *śūdras*, though he is infinitely greater than they, and so they often remain undeveloped in understanding. Vaiṣṇava *dharma* accepts this: whoever, knowing the difference between the worldly and the transcendental truth, has learned transcendental devotion to Kṛṣṇa is the teacher of all *jīvas*; here neither *varṇa* by birth nor an *āśrama* received through rites (*saṁskāras*) matters. It was to teach this truth that Mahāprabhu, the deliverer of the world, sent Pradyumna Miśra, the son of a relative from His former *āśrama*, to learn the truth from Śrī Rāmānanda.

*(2) To Ṭhākura Haridāsa, born in a family of *yavanas*, the Lord gives the*

*title of guru of the world and *ācārya* of the holy name (Nāmācārya) —*

হরিদাস-দ্বারা নাম-মাহাত্ম্য-প্রকাশ ।
সনাতন-দ্বারা ভক্তিসিদ্ধান্ত-বিলাস ॥ ৮৬ ॥

haridāsa-dvārā nāma-māhātmya-prakāśa
through Haridāsa the glory of the holy name the manifestation
sanātana-dvārā bhakti-siddhānta-vilāsa
through Sanātana the play of the conclusions of bhakti

86 Through Haridāsa He revealed the glory of the holy name; through Sanātana, the conclusions of bhakti in all their splendour.

*(3) Śrī Sanātana, though he lived among *mlecchas*, is the *ācārya* of the conclusions of devotion to Kṛṣṇa, that is, of the knowledge of *sambandha*; (4) Śrī Rūpa is the *ācārya* of the *rasa* of Vraja's loving devotion, that is, of *abhidheya* —*

শ্রীরূপ-দ্বারা ব্রজের রস-প্রেম-লীলা ।
কে কহিতে পারে গম্ভীর চৈতন্যের খেলা ? ॥ ৮৭ ॥

śrī-rūpa-dvārā vrajera rasa-prema-līlā
through Śrī Rūpa of Vraja the pastimes of rasa and prema
ke kahite pāre gambhīra caitanyera khelā?
who to tell can profound Caitanya’s play

87 Through Śrī Rūpa He revealed Vraja’s pastimes of rasa and prema. Who can describe the profound play of Caitanya?

By receiving a drop of the ocean of Śrī Caitanya's pastimes, the world is delivered —

শ্রীচৈতন্যলীলা এই — অমৃতের সিন্ধু ।
জগৎ ভাসাইতে পারে যার এক বিন্দু ॥ ৮৮ ॥

śrī-caitanya-līlā ei — amṛtera sindhu
Śrī Caitanya's pastimes these of nectar an ocean
jagat bhāsāite pāre yāra eka bindu
the world to flood can whose one drop

88 These pastimes of Śrī Caitanya are an ocean of nectar, a single drop of which can flood the world.

Anubhāṣya.
A single drop of the nectar ocean of Śrī Caitanya's pastimes can flood the world with *prema*. Śrī Dāsa Gosvāmī, and in a later age Śrī Ṭhākura Narottama, Śrīla Śyāmānanda Prabhu and others, are also manifestations of this magnanimity of Śrī Mahāprabhu.

*In one who drinks with faith the nectar of Caitanya's pastimes, spiritual inclinations awaken, and he gains the knowledge of *sambandha*, *abhidheya* and *prayojana* —*

চৈতন্যচরিতামৃত নিত্য কর পান ।
যাহা হৈতে 'প্রেমানন্দ', 'ভক্তিতত্ত্ব-জ্ঞান' ॥ ৮৯ ॥

caitanya-caritāmṛta nitya kara pāna
the Caitanya-caritāmṛta always do drink
yāhā haite 'premānanda', 'bhakti-tattva-jñāna'
from which 'the bliss of prema' 'knowledge of the truth of bhakti'

89 Drink the *Caitanya-caritāmṛta* constantly, for from it come the bliss of prema and knowledge of the truth of bhakti.

Such are the Lord's pastimes in Nīlācala —

এইমত মহাপ্রভু ভক্তগণ লঞা ।
নীলাচলে বিহরয়ে ভক্তি প্রচারিয়া ॥ ৯০ ॥

ei-mata mahāprabhu bhakta-gaṇa lañā
in this way Mahāprabhu the devotees taking with Him
nīlācale viharaye bhakti pracāriyā
in Nīlācala sports bhakti preaching

90 In this way Mahāprabhu, together with His devotees, enjoyed His pastimes in Nīlācala, preaching bhakti.

*The story of a worldly poet from East Bengal who wore the guise of a *brāhmaṇa* —*

বঙ্গদেশী এক বিপ্র প্রভুর চরিতে ।
নাটক করি' লঞা আইলা শুনাইতে ॥ ৯১ ॥

baṅga-deśī eka vipra prabhura carite
from Bengal a brāhmaṇa on the Lord's life
nāṭaka kari' lañā āilā śunāite
a drama having made taking came to recite

91 A brāhmaṇa from Bengal composed a drama on the Lord's life and brought it with him to recite.[3]

ভগবান্-আচার্য্য-সনে তার পরিচয় ।
তাঁরে মিলি' তাঁর ঘরে করিল আলয় ॥ ৯২ ॥

bhagavān-ācārya-sane tāra paricaya
Bhagavān Ācārya with his acquaintance
tāṁre mili' tāṁra ghare karila ālaya
him having met in his house made his lodging

92 He was acquainted with Bhagavān Ācārya; having met him, he took lodging in his house.

প্রথমে নাটক তেঁহো তাঁরে শুনাইল ।
তাঁর সঙ্গে অনেক বৈষ্ণব নাটক শুনিল ॥ ৯৩ ॥

prathame nāṭaka teṁho tāṁre śunāila
first the drama he to him recited
tāṁra saṅge aneka vaiṣṇava nāṭaka śunila
with him many Vaiṣṇavas the drama heard

93 First he recited the drama to him, and many Vaiṣṇavas heard it along with him.

সবেই প্রশংসে নাটক ‘পরম উত্তম’ ।
মহাপ্রভুরে শুনাইতে সবার হৈল মন ॥ ৯৪ ॥

sabei praśaṁse nāṭaka ‘parama uttama’
all praise the drama ‘most excellent’
mahāprabhure śunāite sabāra haila mana
to Mahāprabhu to recite of all arose the wish

94 Everyone praised the drama as “most excellent”, and all wished to have Mahāprabhu hear it.

The rule: Svarūpa Dāmodara examines everything first —

গীত, শ্লোক, গ্রন্থ, কবিত্ব — যেই করি’ আনে ।
প্রথমে শুনায় সেই স্বরূপের স্থানে ॥ ৯৫ ॥

gīta, śloka, grantha, kavitva — yei kari’ āne
song verse book poem — whatever having made one brings
prathame śunāya sei svarūpera sthāne
first has it heard that in Svarūpa’s presence

95 Whatever song, verse, book or poem anyone composed and brought would first be recited before Svarūpa.

Svarūpa's approval: only after passing his examination does a work receive the Lord's favor —

স্বরূপ-ঠাঞি উত্তরে যদি, লয় তাঁর মন ।
তবে মহাপ্রভু-ঠাঞি করায় শ্রবণ ॥ ৯৬ ॥

svarūpa-ṭhāñi uttare yadi, laya tāṁra mana
before Svarūpa passes if accepts his mind
tabe mahāprabhu-ṭhāñi karāya śravaṇa
then before Mahāprabhu causes the hearing

96 If it passed Svarūpa's scrutiny and won his approval, only then would it be recited before Mahāprabhu.

*The only cause of the magnanimous Lord's anger is a contradiction of the message of *bhakti-siddhānta* —*

'রসাভাস' হয় যদি 'সিদ্ধান্তবিরোধ' ।
সহিতে না পারে প্রভু, মনে হয় ক্রোধ ॥ ৯৭ ॥

'rasābhāsa' haya yadi 'siddhānta-virodha'
'rasābhāsa' is if 'opposition to siddhānta'
sahite nā pāre prabhu, mane haya krodha
to bear not can the Lord in the mind arises anger

97 If there was *rasābhāsa*, a mere semblance of rasa, or anything opposed to *siddhānta*, the Lord could not bear it, and anger arose in His mind.

Anubhāṣya.

Rasābhāsa: "Rasas that lack [any of] the characteristics of *rasa* set out earlier are called *rasābhāsas* by the knowers of *rasa*. They are of three kinds — *uparasas*, *anurasas* and *aparasas* — and are called, in that order, the highest, the middling and the lowest. The twelve *rasas* beginning with *śānta* become *uparasas* when the *sthāyi-bhāva*, the *vibhāvas*, the *anubhāvas* and the rest in them are distorted. The seven *rasas* beginning with *hāsya*, and *śānta* as well, are considered *anurasas* when their *vibhāvas* — devotees and the rest — have no relation to Kṛṣṇa. And if Kṛṣṇa and His opponents become the object (*viṣaya*) and the abode (*āśraya*) of *hāsya* and the other *rasas*, the wise call them *aparasas*. All *bhāvas* have their semblances, and some of them are *rasābhāsas*; yet the knowers of *rasa* call all of them *rasas*, because they are relished." (*Bhakti-rasāmṛta-sindhu*, Uttara-vibhāga, 9th Laharī)

When something at first appears to be *rasa* but, judged by the characteristics of *rasa* described earlier, is incomplete, the *rasikas* call it *rasābhāsa*. *Rasābhāsa* is divided into *uparasa*, *anurasa* and *aparasa*, which are called, respectively, the highest, the middling and the lowest. The twelve *rasas* beginning with *śānta*, in which the *sthāyi-bhāva*, *vibhāva*, *anubhāva* and the rest are distorted, are called *uparasa*. The seven *rasas* beginning with *hāsya*, produced by *vibhāvas* — devotees and the rest — that have no relation

to Kṛṣṇa, together with dry *śānta-rasa*, are called *anurasa*. If Kṛṣṇa and His opponents, the *asuras*, filled with mutually hostile feelings, become the object and the abode of *hāsya* and the other *rasas*, the scholars who know *rasa-tattva* call this *aparasa*. Some call the *bhāvas* *tad-ābhāsa* (their semblance) or *rasābhāsa*; but those expert in *rasa-tattva* call all of these *rasa*, because they are sweet to taste and give joy. Śrī Viśvanātha Cakravartī says: “If two mutually hostile [*rasas*] are joined, that is *rasābhāsa*.” That is, when two opposed *rasas* are joined, *rasābhāsa* arises.

Siddhānta-virodha — contradiction of the *siddhānta* of the path of *bhakti*; contradiction of *tattva*.

অতএব প্রভু কিছু আগে নাহি শুনে ।
এই মর্য্যাদা প্রভু কৈরাছেন নিয়মে ॥ ৯৮ ॥

ataeva prabhu kichu āge nāhi śune
therefore the Lord anything first not hears
ei maryādā prabhu kairāchena niyame
this rule of propriety the Lord has made as a fixed rule

98 Therefore the Lord would hear nothing that Svarūpa had not examined first; He had made this a fixed rule of propriety.

Bhagavān Ācārya's request to Svarūpa; praise of the mundane poet's work —

স্বরূপের ঠাঞি আচার্য্য কৈলা নিবেদন ।
এক কবি প্রভুর নাটক কৈরাছে উত্তম ॥ ৯৯ ॥

svarūpera ṭhāñi ācārya kailā nivedana
before Svarūpa the Ācārya made a request
eka kavi prabhura nāṭaka kairāche uttama
a poet on the Lord a drama has composed excellent

99 Bhagavān Ācārya made a request to Svarūpa: “A poet has composed an excellent drama about the Lord.[4]

আদৌ তুমি শুন, যদি তোমার মন মানে ।
পাছে মহাপ্রভুরে তবে করাইমু শ্রবণে ॥ ১০০ ॥

ādau tumi śuna, yadi tomāra mana māne
first you hear if your mind accepts
pāche mahāprabhure tabe karāimu śravaṇe
afterwards Mahāprabhu then I shall have hear

100 Hear it first yourself, and if you approve of it, I shall then have Mahāprabhu hear it."

*Svarūpa, the *ācārya* foremost among the knowers of *kṛṣṇa-tattva*, who knows the heart, rebukes Bhagavān Ācārya —*

স্বরূপ কহে, — তুমি 'গোপ' পরম-উদার ।
যে-সে শাস্ত্র শুনিতে ইচ্ছা উপজে তোমার ॥ ১০১ ॥

svarūpa kahe, — tumi 'gopa' parama-udāra
Svarūpa says — you a 'cowherd' most generous
ye-se śāstra śunite icchā upaje tomāra
any whatever śāstra to hear desire arises your

101 Svarūpa said, "You are a simple 'cowherd' (*gopa*), and most generous: you wish to hear any writing whatever.

The one cause of Gaura-Kṛṣṇa's displeasure is pointed out —

'যদ্বা-তদ্বা' কবির বাক্যে হয় 'রসাভাস' ।
সিদ্ধান্তবিরুদ্ধ শুনিতে না হয় উল্লাস ॥ ১০২ ॥

'yadvā-tadvā' kavira vākye haya 'rasābhāsa'
'any whatever' of a poet in the words is 'rasābhāsa'
siddhānta-viruddha śunite nā haya ullāsa
opposed to siddhānta to hear not arises joy

102 In the words of just any poet there is *rasābhāsa*, and hearing what is opposed to *siddhānta* brings no joy.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Yadvā tadvā kavi — any poet whatever, that is, those who compose poetry without properly knowing either *rasa-tattva* or the *siddhānta* of the Vaiṣṇavas.

‘রস’, ‘রসাভাস’ যার নাহিক বিচার ।
ভক্তিসিদ্ধান্ত-সিন্ধু নাহি পায় পার ॥ ১০৩ ॥

‘rasa’, ‘rasābhāsa’ yāra nāhika vicāra
‘rasa’ ‘rasābhāsa’ whose there is no discrimination
bhakti-siddhānta-sindhu nāhi pāya pāra
of the conclusions of bhakti the ocean not reaches the shore

103 One who cannot discriminate between rasa and *rasābhāsa* never reaches the far shore of the ocean of *bhakti-siddhānta*.

‘ব্যাকরণ’ নাহি জানে, না জানে ‘অলঙ্কার’ ।
‘নাটকালঙ্কার’-জ্ঞান নাহিক যাহার ॥ ১০৪ ॥

কৃষ্ণলীলা বর্ণিতে না জানে সেই ছার !
বিশেষে দুর্গম এই চৈতন্য-বিহার ! ॥ ১০৫ ॥

‘vyākaraṇa’ nāhi jāne, nā jāne ‘alaṅkāra’
‘grammar’ not knows not knows ‘rhetoric’
‘nāṭakālaṅkāra’-jñāna nāhika yāhāra
‘of the ornaments of drama’ knowledge there is no whose
kṛṣṇa-līlā varṇite nā jāne sei chāra!
Kṛṣṇa’s pastimes to describe not knows that worthless one
viśeṣe durgama ei caitanya-vihāra!
especially inaccessible this play of Caitanya

104–105 A worthless poet who knows neither grammar nor rhetoric, and has no knowledge of the ornaments of drama, does not know how to describe Kṛṣṇa’s pastimes; and these pastimes of Caitanya are especially hard to enter!

Only a devotee of Kṛṣṇa whose life is given to Gaura is qualified to describe

Gaura's pastimes —

কৃষ্ণলীলা, গৌরলীলা সে করে বর্ণন ।
গৌর-পাদপদ্ম যাঁর হয় প্রাণ-ধন ॥ ১০৬ ॥

kṛṣṇa-līlā, gaura-līlā se kare varṇana
Kṛṣṇa's pastimes Gaura's pastimes he does describe
gaura-pāda-padma yāṁra haya prāṇa-dhana
Gaura's lotus feet whose are the wealth of life

106 Only one for whom the lotus feet of Gaura are the very wealth of life can describe the pastimes of Kṛṣṇa and the pastimes of Gaura.

*The mundane poet, who does not aim at Kṛṣṇa's happiness, is an outsider (*bahiraṅga*); the transcendental poet, devoted to Kṛṣṇa's happiness, is one of the intimate circle (*antaraṅga*) —*

গ্রাম্য-কবির কবিত্ব শুনিতে হয় 'দুঃখ' ।
বিদগ্ধ-আত্মীয়-বাক্য শুনিতে হয় 'সুখ' ॥ ১০৭ ॥

grāmya-kavira kavitva śunite haya 'duḥkha'
of a mundane poet the poetry to hear is 'pain'
vidagdha-ātmīya-vākya śunite haya 'sukha'
of one expert and intimate the words to hear is 'joy'

107 To hear the poetry of a mundane poet (*grāmya-kavi*) is painful; to hear the words of one who is expert and intimate (*vidagdha ātmīya*) is a joy.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Grāmya-kavi — poets who compose verses about mundane men and women. ***Vidagdha ātmīya-vākya*** — the composition of one who is our own (*ātmīya*): a person skilled in the knowledge of *tattva* who belongs to the community of pure devotees (that is, warm-hearted and of like aspiration).

The example of Śrī Rūpa, crown jewel of transcendental poets —

রূপ যৈছে দুই নাটক কৈরাছে আরম্ভে ।
শুনিতে আনন্দ বাড়ে যার মুখবন্ধে ॥ ১০৮ ॥

rūpa yaiche dui nāṭaka kairāche ārambhe
Rūpa as two dramas has composed at the outset
śunite ānanda bāḍe yāra mukha-bandhe
to hear joy increases whose in the prologue

108 Take the two dramas Rūpa has composed: merely hearing their prologues makes one's joy grow."

Bhagavān Ācārya insists nonetheless —

ভগবান্-আচার্য্য কহে, — শুন একবার ।
তুমি শুনিলে ভাল-মন্দ জানিবে বিচার ॥ ১০৯ ॥

bhagavān-ācārya kahe, — śuna eka-bāra
Bhagavān Ācārya says — hear once
tumi śunile bhāla-manda jānibe vicāra
you having heard good or bad will know the judgment

109 Bhagavān Ācārya said, "Just hear it once. When you have heard it, you will be able to judge whether it is good or bad."

Because his friend the Ācārya insists, Śrī Svarūpa agrees to listen —

দুই-তিন-দিন আচার্য্য আগ্রহ করিল ।
তাঁর আগ্রহে স্বরূপের শুনিতে ইচ্ছা হৈল ॥ ১১০ ॥

dui-tina-dina ācārya āgraha karila
two or three days the Ācārya insistence made
tāṁra āgrahe svarūpera śunite icchā haila
by his insistence in Svarūpa to hear the desire arose

110 For two or three days the Ācārya pressed him, and at his insistence Svarūpa agreed to hear it.

*The poet recites the *nāndī* verse before Svarūpa —*

সবা লঞা স্বরূপ-গোসাঞি শুনিতে বসিলা ।
তবে সেই কবি নান্দী-শ্লোক পড়িলা ॥ ১১১ ॥

sabā lañā svarūpa-gosāñi śunite vasilā
all taking Svarūpa Gosāñi to hear sat down
tabe sei kavi nāndī-śloka paḍilā
then that poet the nāndī verse recited

111 Svarūpa Gosāñi sat down with everyone to listen, and the poet recited the *nāndī* verse, the opening benediction.

*The *nāndī* verse —*

বিকচকমলনেত্রে শ্রীজগন্নাথসংজ্ঞে
কনকরুচিরিহাত্মন্যাত্মতাং যঃ প্রপন্নঃ ।
প্রকৃতিজড়মশেষং চেতয়ন্নাবিরাসীৎ
স দিশতু তব ভব্যং কৃষ্ণচৈতন্যদেবঃ ॥ ১১২ ॥

vikaca-kamala-netre śrī-jagannātha-saṁjñe
with eyes like blossoming lotuses named Śrī Jagannātha
kanaka-rucir ihātmany ātmatāṁ yaḥ prapannaḥ
golden-hued here in the self selfhood who has attained
prakṛti-jaḍam aśeṣaṁ cetayann āvirāsīt
inert matter all enlivening appeared
sa diśatu tava bhavyaṁ kṛṣṇa-caitanya-devaḥ
He may grant your welfare Kṛṣṇa Caitanya-deva

112 "He of golden lustre has here found His self in the One named Śrī Jagannātha, whose eyes are like blossoming lotuses, and has appeared, bringing consciousness to the whole of inert nature. May that Kṛṣṇa Caitanya-deva grant you good fortune."

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

He placed within Himself — or spread forth — a golden luster and attained His selfhood in Śrī Jagannātha, whose eyes are blossoming lotuses. Giving boundless

consciousness to inert *prakṛti*, He appeared. May that Kṛṣṇa Caitanyadeva bestow welfare upon you.

Anubhāṣya.

kanaka-ruciḥ (whose luster [*ruci*] is like the luster of gold [*kanaka*]) **yaḥ** (Gaura) **iha** (here, in Puruṣottama-kṣetra) **vikaca-kamala-netre** (in Him whose eyes are like blossoming lotuses) **śrī-jagannātha-saṁjñe** (in Him who is called — whose name is — "Śrī Jagannātha") **ātmani** (in the body) **ātmatām** (the status of the owner of the body) **prapannaḥ** (having attained) **prakṛti-jaḍam** (inert by nature — the Deity of Śrī Jagannātha, because the worshipable Deity is seen as wood — so in the poet's sense) **aśeṣaṁ cetayan āvirāsīt** (appeared), **saḥ** (that Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanyadeva) **tava bhavyam** (welfare) **diśatu** (may He bestow).

(In Sarasvatī's sense: **yaḥ** (that) Śrī Kṛṣṇa **śrī-jagannātha-saṁjñe** (in Him who is called Śrī Jagannātha — in the Master of *māyā*, the Dāru-brahma, the Supreme Soul full of the six opulences) **kanaka-rucinā** (in the golden form of Gaura) **ātmatām** (complete nondifference from Him, that is, the form of Jagannātha) **prapannaḥ** (attained); "**saḥ**" and the rest are clear.)

Everyone but Svarūpa praises the verse —

শ্লোক শুনি' সর্ব্বলোক তাহারে বাখানে ।
স্বরূপ কহে, — এই শ্লোক করহ ব্যাখ্যানে ॥ ১১৩ ॥

śloka śuni' sarva-loka tāhāre vākhāne
the verse hearing all the people him praised
svarūpa kahe, — ei śloka karaha vyākhyāne
Svarūpa says — this verse do explain

113 Hearing the verse, everyone praised the poet, but Svarūpa said, "Explain this verse."

*The foolish poet's fault — Māyāvāda, opposed to the *siddhānta* of pure *bhakti* —*

কবি কহে, — জগন্নাথ — সুন্দর-শরীর ।
চৈতন্য-গোসাঞি — শরীরী মহাধীর ॥ ১১৪ ॥

kavi kahe, — jagannātha — sundara-śarīra
the poet says — Jagannātha — the beautiful body
caitanya-gosāñi — śarīrī mahā-dhīra
Caitanya Gosāñi — the embodied one most steady

114 The poet said, "Jagannātha is the beautiful body, and Caitanya Gosāñi, perfectly steady (*mahā-dhīra*), is the one embodied in it (*śarīrī*).

Anubhāṣya.
Śarīrī — the one whose body it is, that is, the embodied one (*dehī*).

সহজে জড়জগতের চেতন করাইতে ।
নীলাচলে মহাপ্রভু হৈলা আবির্ভূতে ॥ ১১৫ ॥

sahaje jaḍa-jagatera cetana karāite
naturally the inert world conscious to make
nīlācale mahāprabhu hailā āvirbhūte
in Nīlācala Mahāprabhu became manifest

115 To bestow consciousness on the inert world, as is His nature, Mahāprabhu has appeared in Nīlācala."

*Everyone rejoiced, yet Śrī Svarūpa — the Vaiṣṇava *ācārya*, the teacher of the world — grows angry and shows mercy: with the sword of scriptural *siddhānta* he cuts down the false doctrine —*

শুনিয়া সবার হৈল আনন্দিত মন ।
দুঃখ পাঞা স্বরূপ কহে সক্রোধ বচন ॥ ১১৬ ॥

śuniyā sabāra haila ānandita mana
hearing of all became joyful the mind
duḥkha pāñā svarūpa kahe sakrodha vacana
pain feeling Svarūpa speaks angry words

116 Hearing this, everyone was delighted, but Svarūpa, deeply pained, spoke angry words:

*The cause of the anger: (1) regarding Viṣṇu as a *jīva* leads to hell —*

আরে মূর্খ, আপনার কৈলি সর্ব্বনাশ !
দুই ত' ঈশ্বরে তোর নাহিক বিশ্বাস ! ॥ ১১৭ ॥

āre mūrkha, āpanāra kaili sarva-nāśa!
O fool your own you have made utter ruin
dui ta' īśvare tora nāhika viśvāsa!
in the two indeed Lords your there is no faith

117 "O fool, you have brought about your own utter ruin! You have no faith in either of the two Lords!

পূর্ণানন্দ-চিৎস্বরূপ জগন্নাথ-রায় ।
তাঁরে কৈলি জড়-নশ্বর-প্রাকৃত-কায়! ॥ ১১৮ ॥

pūrṇānanda-citsvarūpa jagannātha-rāya
full of bliss a form of pure spirit Lord Jagannātha
tāṁre kaili jaḍa-naśvara-prākṛta-kāya!
Him you have made an inert, perishable, material body

118 Lord Jagannātha is full of bliss, a form of pure spirit, yet you have made Him out to be an inert, perishable, material body!

Anubhāṣya.

Someone may see in the Deity of Jagannātha only a wooden image (*pratimā*) and think Him perishable, made of material substances, a mere inert object. By the word of the *Padma Purāṇa* — "One who regards the worshipable Viṣṇu as stone … is a dweller in hell" — whoever thinks this way commits an offense. For the Deity (*arcā-vigraha*) is completely nondifferent from Śrī Kṛṣṇa, whose form is eternity, knowledge and bliss, and the devotee of Bhagavān, with eyes of *bhakti* lit by the bliss of *prema*, sees Him directly as the complete form of eternity, knowledge and bliss.

পূর্ণ-ষড়ৈশ্বর্য্য চৈতন্য — স্বয়ং ভগবান্ ।
তাঁরে কৈলি ক্ষুদ্র-জীব স্ফুলিঙ্গ-সমান ! ॥ ১১৯ ॥

pūrṇa-ṣaḍ-aiśvarya caitanya — svayaṁ bhagavān
full of the six opulences Caitanya — Svayam Bhagavān
tāṁre kaili kṣudra-jīva sphuliṅga-samāna!
Him you have made a tiny jīva a spark like

119 Caitanya, full in all six opulences, is Svayam Bhagavān, the Supreme Lord Himself, yet you have made Him out to be a tiny jīva, like a spark!

Anubhāṣya.

From the words of the *śruti*, "As sparks fly up from a fire …,"[9] we learn that the *jīva* is like a spark of the fire that is the great Viṣṇu; that is, the *jīva* is a particle of spirit (*cit-kaṇa*). A *jīva* under the sway of *māyā* is capable of being bound by matter. But Śrī Caitanyadeva is Parameśvara, whose form is eternity, knowledge and bliss, the cause of all causes; and His having taken a human form does not mean that He is a tiny *jīva* subject to matter. He is the Master of *māyā*, full of the six opulences, Svayaṁ Bhagavān, the son of Yaśodā. (*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 1.11.39): "This is the lordship of the Lord: though He abides within *prakṛti*, He is not bound by its *guṇas*, though they are ever about Him — just as the intelligence that has taken shelter of Him is not bound by them."

*The audacity of one who, relying on sense-born knowledge and logic and ignorant of *bhakti-siddhānta*, sets out to describe Kṛṣṇa —*

দুই-ঠাঞি অপরাধে পাইবি দুর্গতি !
অতত্ত্বজ্ঞ 'তত্ত্ব' বর্ণে, তার এই গতি ! ॥ ১২০ ॥

dui-ṭhāñi aparādhe pāibi durgati!
in two places by the offence you will get a dire fate
atattva-jña 'tattva' varṇe, tāra ei gati!
one ignorant of truth 'truth' describes his this fate

120 For this offence against both you will meet a dire fate! When one ignorant of the truth describes the truth, this is the end he comes to!

Anubhāṣya.

Dui-ṭhāñi (in two places) — Śrī Jagannāthadeva and Śrī Caitanyadeva. The poet took Them both to belong to the material world, as matter and as a *jīva*: he supposed that the particle of spirit residing in the material body of the One had

entered the material body of the other. Hence the offense lies in two places. ***Atattva-jña*** — one who has not grasped *tattva*, that is, a Māyāvādī *ahaṅgrahopāsaka* (who worships himself as God), a *karmī* who enjoys the fruits of his work, or a self-willed person devoted to the senses, who cannot tell the real from the unreal. ***Tattva varṇe*** — describes *tattva*, that is, what concerns Bhagavān.

*(2) The blunder (*pramāda*) is an offense: positing in Īśvara a difference between the body and the embodied one —*

আর এক কৈরাছ পরম ‘প্রমাদ’ !
দেহ-দেহি-ভেদ ঈশ্বরে কৈলে ‘অপরাধ’ ! ॥ ১২১ ॥

āra eka kairācha parama ‘pramāda’!
and one you have made great ‘blunder’
deha-dehi-bheda īśvare kaile ‘aparādha’!
the difference of body and embodied in the Lord you made ‘an offence’

121 You have made yet another great blunder (*pramāda*): by distinguishing between body and embodied in the Lord, you have committed an offence!

Anubhāṣya.

If one regards Īśvara as one does a bound *jīva* and holds His body and His embodied self (*dehī*) to be different things, that is an “offense.” In the material world a bound *jīva* has a bodily existence fashioned by *guṇa-māyā*, and a *jīva*'s self-awareness fashioned by *jīva-māyā*, the marginal potency (*taṭastha-śakti*). The difference between Īśvara and the bound *jīva* is this. Īśvara bestows the fruits of *karma* and rules over them; that is, He is the cause of all causes, the Master of *māyā*, the Lord (*prabhu*) and the all-pervading truth (*vibhu-tattva*). The *jīva*, in the bound state, enjoys the fruits of *karma* and is subject to them, and even in the liberated state, in his own true nature, he is engaged in serving Īśvara. In other words, Īśvara is never under the control of *māyā*, whereas the *jīva* is liable to fall under it. Īśvara is immeasurable, undivided consciousness; the *jīva* is measurable, fragmentary consciousness.

The perishable, transient body of a bound *jīva* is *māyic*, that is, material. The transcendental body of a liberated, pure *jīva* is eternal; and Īśvara, who is beyond

māyā, is also an eternal form endowed with features (*saviśeṣa-vigraha*). Though His eternal form appears in the world by the power of His own inconceivable potency, it is never *māyic* or material and never bears the qualities of this world. (*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 1.11.39): "This is the lordship of the Lord: though He abides within *prakṛti*, He is not bound by its *guṇas*, though they are ever about Him — just as the intelligence that has taken shelter of Him is not bound by them." To try to separate the body from the embodied one on the pretext of making the eternal form "featureless" (*nirviśeṣa*) is a work of grave offense.

The name, form and essential nature of Viṣṇu, the nondual Knowledge, are one —

ঈশ্বরের নাহি কভু দেহ-দেহি-ভেদ ।
স্বরূপ, দেহ, — চিদানন্দ, নাহিক বিভেদ ॥ ১২২ ॥

īśvarera nāhi kabhu deha-dehi-bheda
of the Lord there is not ever body–embodied difference
svarūpa, deha, — cid-ānanda, nāhika vibheda
His own form body — spirit and bliss there is no difference

122 In the Lord there is never any difference between body and embodied. His own form (*svarūpa*) and His body are both spirit and bliss; there is no difference between them.

Anubhāṣya.
The nondual Knowledge (*advaya-jñāna*) is Kṛṣṇa, the son of the king of Vraja. In determining the nature of the Truth, the verse *vadanti tat tattva-vidaḥ*[10] refutes the idea of duality in the one Parameśvara, who has no second. He is the nondual Knowledge; therefore His name, form, qualities and pastimes are not distinct from one another as the things of the material world are — they must be known as absolutely "nondifferent." It is precisely by seeing in Īśvara a difference between body and embodied self that one mistakes Him for a "bound *jīva*," for a bound *jīva* lacks the perception of the nondual Knowledge.

Evidence —

দেহ-দেহি-বিভাগোঽযং নেশ্বরে বিদ্যতে ক্বচিৎ ॥ ১২৩ ॥

deha-dehi-vibhāgo 'yaṁ
of body and embodied division this
neśvare vidyate kvacit
not in the Lord exists ever

123 "This division of body and embodied never exists in the Lord." (Kūrma Purāṇa)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
In Īśvara there is no difference between the body and its possessor (*dehī*).

Anubhāṣya.
īśvare (in the Supreme Soul, in Bhagavān, the Truth endowed with features) **ayaṁ deha-dehi-vibhāgaḥ** (a *māyā*-made difference of this kind: the name is one thing and its bearer another; the form one thing and the possessor of the form another; the quality one thing and its possessor another; the pastime one thing and its performer another — in Viṣṇu, the nondual Knowledge, made of pure *sattva*, in Goloka, in Paravyoma, in Devī-dhāma or within the fourteen worlds) **kvacit** (anywhere) **na vidyate** (does not exist).

নাতঃ পরং পরম যদ্ভবতঃ স্বরূপ-
মানন্দমাত্রমবিকল্পমবিদ্ধবর্চ্চঃ ।
পশ্যামি বিশ্বসৃজমেকমবিশ্বমাত্মন্
ভূতেন্দ্রিয়াত্মকমদস্ত উপাশ্রিতোঽস্মি ॥ ১২৪ ॥

nātaḥ paraṁ parama yad bhavataḥ svarūpam
not than this higher O Supreme which Your form
ānanda-mātram avikalpam aviddha-varcaḥ
pure bliss free of difference of unobscured radiance
paśyāmi viśva-sṛjam ekam aviśvam ātman
I see of the universe the creator one distinct from the universe O Self
bhūtendriyātmakam adas ta upāśrito 'smi
the source of the elements and senses that Your sheltered I am

124 "O Supreme Lord, I see nothing higher than this form of Yours, which is pure bliss, free of all difference, its radiance unobscured. You are the one creator of the universe, yet You are distinct from it, O Self, and You are the

source of the elements and the senses. I have taken shelter of that form of Yours." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 3.9.3)[5]

Anubhāṣya.
See Madhya 25.36.

তদ্বা ইদং ভুবনমঙ্গল মঙ্গলায়
ধ্যানে স্ম নো দর্শিতং ত উপাসকানাম্ ।
তস্মৈ নমো ভগবতেঽনুবিধেম তুভ্যং
যোঽনাদৃতো নরকভাগ্‌ভিরসৎপ্রসঙ্গৈঃ ॥ ১২৫ ॥

tad vā idaṁ bhuvana-maṅgala maṅgalāya
that indeed this (form) O good of the worlds for the good
dhyāne sma no darśitaṁ ta upāsakānām
in meditation indeed to us shown by You to the worshippers
tasmai namo bhagavate 'nuvidhema tubhyaṁ
to Him obeisance to Bhagavān we offer to You
yo 'nādṛto naraka-bhāgbhir asat-prasaṅgaiḥ
who is not honoured by those bound for hell attached to false arguments

125 "O good of all the worlds, for our good You have shown this very form to us, Your worshippers, in meditation. We bow down to You, Bhagavān, whom those bound for hell, attached to false arguments, do not honour." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 3.9.4)[6]

Anubhāṣya.
See Madhya 25.37.

*The "difference" between Viṣṇu, the Supreme Lord, and the dependent *jīva**

—

কাঁহা 'পূর্ণানন্দৈশ্বর্য্য' কৃষ্ণ 'মহেশ্বর' !
কাঁহা 'ক্ষুদ্র' জীব 'দুঃখী', 'মায়ার কিঙ্কর' ! ॥ ১২৬ ॥

kāṁhā 'pūrṇānandaiśvarya' kṛṣṇa 'maheśvara'!
where 'full of bliss and opulence' Kṛṣṇa 'the Great Lord'
kāṁhā 'kṣudra' jīva 'duḥkhī', 'māyāra kiṅkara'!
where 'tiny' jīva 'miserable' 'servant of māyā'

126 Where is Kṛṣṇa, full of bliss and opulence, the Great Lord (*Maheśvara*)? And where is the tiny, miserable jīva, a servant of māyā?

Anubhāṣya.
Where is Kṛṣṇa, the great Parameśvara, the form of majesty full of complete bliss — and where the tiny bound *jīva*, a slave on the path of *māyā*, full of great suffering! Let alone equality between the two — they cannot even be compared.

হ্লাদিন্যা সম্বিদাশ্লিষ্টঃ সচ্চিদানন্দ ঈশ্বরঃ ।
স্বাবিদ্যা সংবৃতো জীবঃ সংক্লেশনিকরাকরঃ ॥ ১২৭ ॥

hlādinyā samvidāśliṣṭaḥ
by hlādinī embraced by saṁvit
sac-cid-ānanda īśvaraḥ
eternal being, consciousness and bliss the Lord
svāvidyā saṁvṛto jīvaḥ
by its own ignorance covered the jīva
saṁkleśa-nikarākaraḥ
a mine of a multitude of miseries

127 "The Lord, embraced by the hlādinī and saṁvit potencies, is eternal being, consciousness and bliss; the jīva, covered by its own ignorance, is a mine of countless miseries." (words of Viṣṇusvāmī quoted by Śrīdhara Svāmī in his commentary on Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 1.7.5–6)[7]

Anubhāṣya.
See Madhya 18.114.

Everyone is astonished —

শুনি' সভাসদের হৈল মহাচমৎকার ।
সত্য কহে গোসাঞি, দুঁহারে কৈরাছে তিরস্কার ॥ ১২৮ ॥

śuni' sabhāsadera haila mahācamatkāra
hearing of the assembly there was great astonishment
satya kahe gosāñi, dum̐hāre kairāche tiraskāra
truly speaks Gosāñi both he has insulted

128 Hearing this, the whole assembly was struck with wonder: "The Gosāñi speaks the truth! The poet has insulted both."

The shame, fear and astonishment of the mundane poet, whose knowledge rests on the senses —

শুনিয়া কবির হৈল লজ্জা, ভয়, বিস্ময় ।
হংস-মধ্যে বক যেন কিছু নাহি কয় ॥ ১২৯ ॥

śuniyā kavira haila lajjā, bhaya, vismaya
hearing of the poet arose shame fear amazement
haṁsa-madhye baka yena kichu nāhi kaya
swans among a heron like anything not says

129 The poet was filled with shame, fear and amazement; like a heron among swans, he could say nothing.

The abundant mercy of the magnanimous Śrī Svarūpa —

তার দুঃখ দেখি' স্বরূপ পরম-সদয় ।
উপদেশ কৈলা তারে যৈছে 'হিত' হয় ॥ ১৩০ ॥

tāra duḥkha dekhi' svarūpa parama-sadaya
his distress seeing Svarūpa most merciful
upadeśa kailā tāre yaiche 'hita' haya
instruction gave to him so that 'good' may come

130 Seeing his distress, the most merciful Svarūpa instructed him in a way that would bring him true good:

*Through him, the supreme beneficial instruction to all *jīvas* from Śrī*

*Svarūpa, the Vaiṣṇava *ācārya* nondifferent from Gaura —*

যাহ', ভাগবত পড় বৈষ্ণবের স্থানে ।
একান্ত আশ্রয় কর চৈতন্য-চরণে ॥ ১৩১ ॥

yāha', bhāgavata paḍa vaiṣṇavera sthāne
go the Bhāgavata study from a Vaiṣṇava
ekānta āśraya kara caitanya-caraṇe
exclusive shelter take at Caitanya's feet

131 "Go and study the *Bhāgavata* under a Vaiṣṇava, and take exclusive shelter at the feet of Caitanya.

Anubhāṣya.

If one goes to read or hear the *Bhāgavatam* from a Māyāvādī devoted to featureless *kevalādvaita*, from a grammarian clever with words but devoid of *bhakti*, or from a sense-enjoyer greedy for wealth, one will not attain love for Kṛṣṇa that way; instead of *kṛṣṇa-rasa*, only the enjoyment of material *rasa* will grow. One must read the *Bhāgavatam* only from a *paramahaṁsa* Vaiṣṇava who has renounced the objects of the senses. The Vaiṣṇava's only wealth is the meaning of the *Bhāgavatam* revealed by Śrī Caitanyacandra, and one receives it by taking exclusive shelter at His feet.

*Knowledge of the *siddhānta* of pure *bhakti* comes only through the association of Caitanya's devotees, those who cultivate the pure function of the spirit —*

চৈতন্যের ভক্তগণের নিত্য কর 'সঙ্গ' ।
তবে ত' জানিবা সিদ্ধান্তসমুদ্র-তরঙ্গ ॥ ১৩২ ॥

caitanyera bhakta-gaṇera nitya kara 'saṅga'
of Caitanya's devotees always keep 'the company'
tabe ta' jānibā siddhānta-samudra-taraṅga
then indeed you will know of the ocean of siddhānta the waves

132 Always keep the company of Caitanya's devotees; then you will come to know the waves of the ocean of *siddhānta*.

Anubhāṣya.

The devotees of Śrī Caitanya are eternal associates of Hari and the only knowers of transcendental *tattva*. If one associates with them wholly and without interruption, all the *jīva*'s ignorance born of material enjoyment will be dispelled, and the true *siddhānta* of pure *bhakti* will be revealed to him.

*Knowledge of *bhakti-siddhānta* is the fruit of learning and scholarship —*

তবে পাণ্ডিত্য তোমার হইবে সফল ।
কৃষ্ণের স্বরূপ-লীলা বর্ণিবা নির্ম্মল ॥ ১৩৩ ॥

tabe pāṇḍitya tomāra haibe saphala
then learning your will become fruitful
kṛṣṇera svarūpa-līlā varṇibā nirmala
Kṛṣṇa's true nature and pastimes you will describe purely

133 Then your learning will bear fruit, and you will describe Kṛṣṇa's true nature and pastimes purely, without fault.

এই শ্লোক কৈরাছ পাঞা সন্তোষ ।
তোমার হৃদয়ের অর্থে দুঁহায় লাগে 'দোষ' ॥ ১৩৪ ॥

ei śloka kairācha pāñā santoṣa
this verse you have composed having felt satisfaction
tomāra hṛdayera arthe duṁhāya lāge 'doṣa'
your of the heart by the meaning to both attaches 'fault'

134 You composed this verse with great satisfaction, but the meaning you had in mind lays fault on both Lords.

Anubhāṣya.
Duṁhāya — in Śrī Jagannāthadeva and in Śrī Gaurahari.

*Even through the words of a fool or an enemy who reviles Kṛṣṇa, pure Sarasvatī — Kṛṣṇa's servant, the embodied message of *bhakti-siddhānta* —*

serves Gaura-Kṛṣṇa —

তুমি যৈছে-তৈছে কহ, না জানিয়া রীতি ।
সরস্বতী সেই শব্দে কৈরাছে স্তুতি ॥ ১৩৫ ॥

tumi yaiche-taiche kaha, nā jāniyā rīti
you any which way speak not knowing the proper way
sarasvatī sei śabde kairāche stuti
Sarasvatī with those words has made praise

135 You spoke at random, not knowing the proper way; yet with those very words Sarasvatī has offered praise.

Anubhāṣya.

Out of ignorance you do not see the difference between Māyāvāda and the path of *bhakti*. That is why the way you expressed your idea is not good: it came out any which way. But Sarasvatī, the goddess who presides over composition, has used these very clumsy words of yours to praise her own worshipable Gaura-Kṛṣṇa.

যৈছে ইন্দ্র, দৈত্যাদি করে কৃষ্ণের ভর্ৎসন ।
সেইশব্দে সরস্বতী করেন স্তবন ॥ ১৩৬ ॥

yaiche indra, daityādi kare kṛṣṇera bhartsana
as Indra the demons and others do of Kṛṣṇa rebuke
sei-śabde sarasvatī karena stavana
with those words Sarasvatī does praise

136 When Indra, the demons and others rebuke Kṛṣṇa, Sarasvatī offers praise with those very words.

(a) An example: the reviling words of Indra, whose knowledge rests on the senses —

বাচালং বালিশং স্তব্ধমজ্ঞং পণ্ডিতমানিনম্ ।
কৃষ্ণং মর্ত্ত্যমুপাশ্রিত্য গোপা মে চক্রুরপ্রিয়ম্ ॥ ১৩৭ ॥

vācālaṁ bāliśaṁ stabdham
talkative childish stubborn
ajñaṁ paṇḍita-māninam
ignorant thinking Himself learned
kṛṣṇaṁ martyam upāśritya
Kṛṣṇa a mortal having taken shelter of
gopā me cakrur apriyam
the cowherds to me have done an offence

137 "Taking shelter of Kṛṣṇa — a talkative, childish, stubborn, ignorant mortal who thinks Himself learned — these cowherds have offended me." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 10.25.5)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Indra said: "Relying on this talkative, foolish, impudent, ignorant, mortal Kṛṣṇa, who thinks Himself learned, the cowherds have done what displeases me."

Anubhāṣya.
gopāḥ vācālaṁ (very talkative) **bāliśaṁ** (a child, or a fool) **stabdham** (ill-mannered) **ajñaṁ** (who does not foresee the consequences) **paṇḍita-māninaṁ** (who thinks Himself learned) **martyam** (a mortal man) **kṛṣṇam upāśritya** (relying on) **me** (to me) **apriyam** (what is contrary to my wish — an insult) **cakruḥ**.

(Although Indra's words are used to revile, pure Sarasvatī praises Kṛṣṇa through his speech:) **vācālaṁ** (He who by speech [*vācā*] is fully [*alam*] able — the source of the *śāstra*, He who set the Vedas in motion) **bāliśaṁ** (childlike — free of self-importance, without pride) **stabdham** (who bows to no one, for there is no one else worthy of worship) **ajñaṁ** (He beyond whom there is no other knower [*jña*], no other intelligence — the omniscient) **paṇḍita-māninaṁ** (He who is served by many and highly honored by the *paṇḍitas*, the knowers of Brahman or the knowers of bondage and liberation) **martyam** (He who, out of affection for His devotees, appears as a human being) **kṛṣṇam** (the Supreme Brahman, whose form is eternity, knowledge and bliss); the rest is clear.

Indra, puffed up with mundane pride —

ঐশ্বর্য্য মদে মত্ত ইন্দ্র, — যেন মাতোয়াল ।
বুদ্ধিনাশ হৈল, কেবল নাহিক সাম্ভাল ॥ ১৩৮ ॥

aiśvarya made matta indra, — yena mātoyāla
by the intoxication of opulence maddened Indra — like a drunkard
buddhi-nāśa haila, kevala nāhika sāmbhāla
loss of intelligence occurred at all there is no self-control

138 Indra, maddened by the intoxication of his opulence, was like a drunkard: his intelligence was lost, and he had no self-control at all.

Anubhāṣya.
Sāmbhāla (a Hindi word) — good sense, or caution; in colloquial speech, *sāmāla*.

Through the very words of reviling in Indra's mouth, pure Sarasvatī praises Kṛṣṇa —

ইন্দ্র বলে, — মুঞি কৃষ্ণের কৈরাছি নিন্দন ।
তারই মুখে সরস্বতী করেন স্তবন ॥ ১৩৯ ॥

indra bale, — muñi kṛṣṇera kairāchi nindana
Indra says — I of Kṛṣṇa have made reviling
tārai mukhe sarasvatī karena stavana
from his very mouth Sarasvatī does praise

139 Indra says, "I have reviled Kṛṣṇa," yet from his very mouth Sarasvatī offers praise.

*Pure Sarasvatī explains the words: (1) *vācāla*, (2) *bāliśa* —*

'বাচাল' কহিয়ে — 'বেদপ্রবর্ত্তক' ধন্য ।
'বালিশ' — তথাপি 'শিশু-প্রায়' গর্ব্বশূন্য ॥ ১৪০ ॥

'vācāla' kahiye — 'veda-pravartaka' dhanya
'talkative' we call — 'the promulgator of the Vedas' glorious
'bāliśa' — tathāpi 'śiśu-prāya' garva-śūnya
'childish' — yet 'like a child' free of pride

140 '*Vācāla*' (talkative) means the glorious One who set the Vedas in motion; and '*bāliśa*' (childish) means that, great as He is, He is like a child, free of pride.

*(3) *stabdha*, (4) *ajña* —*

বন্দ্যাভাবে ‘অনম্র’ — ‘স্তব্ধ’-শব্দে কয়।
যাহা হৈতে অন্য ‘বিজ্ঞ’ নাহি — সে ‘অজ্ঞ’ হয় ॥ ১৪১ ॥

vandyābhāve ‘anamra’ — ‘stabdha’-śabde kaya
for want of one to honour ‘not bowing’ — by the word ‘stabdha’ is said
yāhā haite anya ‘vijña’ nāhi — se ‘ajña’ haya
than whom another ‘knower’ there is not — He ‘ajña’ is

141 Because there is no one for Him to honour, He bows to none: this is what the word ‘*stabdha*’ (stubborn) says. And He beyond whom there is no other knower is ‘*ajña*’ (ignorant) — there is nothing for Him to learn.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Vandyābhāve anamra — stabdha-śabde kaya: there is no one whom He must worship, and so He bows to no one — this is what the word *stabdha* expresses.

*(5) *paṇḍita-mānī* and (6) *martya* —*

পণ্ডিতের মান্য-পাত্র — হয় ‘পণ্ডিতমানী’।
তথাপি ভক্তবাৎসল্যে ‘মনুষ্য’-অভিমানী ॥ ১৪২ ॥

paṇḍitera mānya-pātra — haya ‘paṇḍita-mānī’
of the learned the object of honour — is ‘paṇḍita-mānī’
tathāpi bhakta-vātsalye ‘manuṣya’-abhimānī
still out of affection for devotees ‘human’ considers Himself

142 The one honoured by the learned is ‘*paṇḍita-mānī*’; yet out of affection for His devotees He regards Himself as a human being, a ‘mortal’.

(b) An example: the reviling words of Jarāsandha, an enemy —

জরাসন্ধ কহে, — কৃষ্ণ — ‘পুরুষ-অধম’।
তোর সঙ্গে না যুঝিমু, ‘যাহি বন্ধুহন্’ ॥ ১৪৩ ॥

jarāsandha kahe, — kṛṣṇa — 'puruṣa-adhama'
Jarāsandha says — Kṛṣṇa — 'the lowest of men'
tora saṅge nā yujhimu, 'yāhi bandhu-han'
with You not I shall fight 'go away, slayer of kinsmen'

143 Jarāsandha said, "Kṛṣṇa is the lowest of men! I will not fight with You — go away, slayer of Your kinsmen!"

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Nā yujhimu, 'yāhi bandhu-han' — "O slayer of Your kin, go away; I will not fight with You."

Thus ends the fifth chapter of the "Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya."

Anubhāṣya.

Addressing Kṛṣṇa, Jarāsandha said: "O lowest of men (*puruṣādhama*), O slayer of Your kin (*bandhu-han*), go away; I will not fight with You." Through these words of Jarāsandha pure Sarasvatī praises Kṛṣṇa. The word *puruṣādhama* (a *bahuvrīhi* compound) means "He compared with whom all men (*puruṣas*) are low (*adhama*)," that is, "Puruṣottama." A *bandhu* is that which holds out the hope of success in *saṁsāra*: *māyā*, or *avidyā*, is the *bandhu*. One who destroys *māyā*, or *avidyā*, is *bandhu-hā*; in the vocative, *bandhu-han*.

*Through these words of reviling pure Sarasvatī praises Kṛṣṇa: (1) *puruṣādhama* —*

যাহা হৈতে অন্য পুরুষসকল — 'অধম' ।
সেই হয় 'পুরুষাধম' — সরস্বতীর মন ॥ ১৪৪ ॥

yāhā haite anya puruṣa-sakala — 'adhama'
than whom other persons all — 'lower'
sei haya 'puruṣādhama' — sarasvatīra mana
He is 'puruṣādhama' — Sarasvatī's meaning

144 He in comparison with whom all other persons are lower is '*puruṣādhama*' — that is Sarasvatī's meaning.

*(2) *bandhu-han* —*

‘বান্ধে সবারে’ — তাতে অবিদ্যা ‘বন্ধু’ হয়।
‘অবিদ্যা-নাশক’ — ‘বন্ধুহন্’-শব্দে কয় ॥ ১৪৫ ॥

‘bāndhe sabāre’ — tāte avidyā ‘bandhu’ haya
‘binds all’ — therefore ignorance ‘bandhu’ is
‘avidyā-nāśaka’ — ‘bandhu-han’-śabde kaya
‘destroyer of ignorance’ — by the word ‘bandhu-han’ is said

145 Because it binds everyone, ignorance (*avidyā*) is the ‘*bandhu*’; so the word ‘*bandhu-han*’ means the destroyer of ignorance.

An example: the reviling words of Śiśupāla, an enemy —

এইমত শিশুপাল করিল নিন্দন।
সেইবাক্যে সরস্বতী করেন স্তবন ॥ ১৪৬ ॥

ei-mata śiśupāla karila nindana
in this way Śiśupāla did reviling
sei-vākye sarasvatī karena stavana
with those words Sarasvatī does praise

146 In the same way Śiśupāla reviled Kṛṣṇa, and with those very words Sarasvatī offered praise.

Anubhāṣya.
With the very words with which Śiśupāla reviled Kṛṣṇa, pure Sarasvatī likewise praises Kṛṣṇa.

*Svarūpa explains the mundane poet's words as praise of Kṛṣṇa and establishes the nondifference of the Dāru-brahma, Jagannātha, from the moving Brahman (*jaṅgama-brahma*), Gaurahari —*

তৈছে এই শ্লোকে তোমার অর্থে ‘নিন্দা’ আইসে।
সরস্বতীর অর্থ শুন, যাতে ‘স্তুতি’ ভাসে ॥ ১৪৭ ॥

taiche ei śloke tomāra arthe 'nindā' āise
so in this verse by your meaning 'blame' comes
sarasvatīra artha śuna, yāte 'stuti' bhāse
Sarasvatī's meaning hear in which 'praise' shines

147 So too with this verse: in your meaning it speaks blame. Now hear Sarasvatī's meaning, in which praise shines forth.

জগন্নাথ হয় কৃষ্ণের 'আত্মস্বরূপ' ।
কিন্তু ইঁহা দারুব্রহ্ম — 'স্থাবর-স্বরূপ' ॥ ১৪৮ ॥

jagannātha haya kṛṣṇera 'ātma-svarūpa'
Jagannātha is Kṛṣṇa's 'very self'
kintu iṁhā dāru-brahma — 'sthāvara-svarūpa'
but here the Dāru-brahma — 'an immobile form'

148 Jagannātha is Kṛṣṇa's very self (*ātma-svarūpa*), but here He is the Dāru-brahma, in an immobile form.[8]

*To deliver the world, the one *vigraha*, by the power of His will (*icchā-śakti*), is manifest in two forms —*

তাঁহা-সহ আত্মতা একরূপ হঞা ।
কৃষ্ণ একতত্ত্বরূপ — দুইরূপ হঞা ॥ ১৪৯ ॥

tāṁhā-saha ātmatā eka-rūpa hañā
with Him selfhood one form being
kṛṣṇa eka-tattva-rūpa — dui-rūpa hañā
Kṛṣṇa the one truth — two forms having become

149 Caitanya is one with Him in self and form: Kṛṣṇa, the one truth, has appeared in two forms.

সংসারতারণ-হেতু যেই ইচ্ছা-শক্তি ।
তাহার মিলন করি' একতা ঐছে প্রাপ্তি ॥ ১৫০ ॥

saṁsāra-tāraṇa-hetu yei icchā-śakti
for deliverance from saṁsāra that will-potency
tāhāra milana kari' ekatā aiche prāpti
of that union making oneness thus is attained

150 Uniting in that will (*icchā-śakti*) whose aim is to deliver souls from *saṁsāra*, They attain such oneness.

সকল সংসারী-লোকের করিতে উদ্ধার ।
গৌর-জঙ্গম-রূপে কৈলা অবতার ॥ ১৫১ ॥

sakala saṁsārī-lokera karite uddhāra
all worldly people to deliver
gaura-jaṅgama-rūpe kailā avatāra
of Gaura in the moving form made descent

151 To deliver all the people of the world, He descended in the moving form of Gaura.

**Jīvas* are delivered by seeing Jagannātha and through Gaura's preaching —*

জগন্নাথের দর্শনে খণ্ডায় সংসার ।
সব-দেশের সব-লোক নারে আসিবার ॥ ১৫২ ॥

jagannāthera darśane khaṇḍāya saṁsāra
by the sight of Jagannātha is cut saṁsāra
saba-deśera saba-loka nāre āsibāra
of all lands all people cannot come

152 By seeing Jagannātha one is freed from *saṁsāra*, but not all the people of every land can come to Him.

শ্রীকৃষ্ণচৈতন্যপ্রভু দেশে দেশে যাঞা ।
সব-লোকে নিস্তারিলা জঙ্গম-ব্রহ্ম হঞা ॥ ১৫৩ ॥

śrī-kṛṣṇa-caitanya-prabhu deśe deśe yāñā
Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya Prabhu land to land going
saba-loke nistārilā jaṅgama-brahma hañā
all people delivered the moving Brahman becoming

153 So Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya Prabhu, going from land to land as the moving Brahman (*jaṅgama-brahma*), delivered everyone.

সরস্বতীর অর্থ এই কহিলুঁ বিবরণ ।
এহো ভাগ্য তোমার — ঐছে করিলা বর্ণন ॥ ১৫৪ ॥

sarasvatīra artha ei kahiluṁ vivaraṇa
Sarasvatī's meaning this I have told the explanation
eho bhāgya tomāra — aiche karilā varṇana
this too fortune yours — thus you made the description

154 This is the explanation I have given of Sarasvatī's meaning. It is your good fortune, too, that you described Them in this way.

*Even in reviling Kṛṣṇa, the Name uttered as *stobha* — a *nāmābhāsa* — brings liberation*[11] —

কৃষ্ণে গালি দিতে করে নাম উচ্চারণ ।
সেই নাম হয় তার 'মুক্তি'র কারণ ॥ ১৫৫ ॥

kṛṣṇe gāli dite kare nāma uccāraṇa
Kṛṣṇa to abuse makes the name utterance
sei nāma haya tāra 'mukti'ra kāraṇa
that name becomes his of 'liberation' the cause

155 One may utter Kṛṣṇa's name only to abuse Him, yet that very name becomes the cause of his liberation."

The poet surrenders at the feet of the Vaiṣṇavas —

তবে সেই কবি সবার চরণে পড়িয়া ।
সবা শরণ লৈল দন্তে তৃণ লঞা ॥ ১৫৬ ॥

tabe sei kavi sabāra caraṇe paḍiyā
then that poet at the feet of all falling
sabā śaraṇa laila dante tṛṇa lañā
of all shelter took in the teeth straw holding

156 Then the poet fell at everyone's feet and, holding straw between his teeth, took shelter of them all.

First the devotees' mercy, and through it, Mahāprabhu's mercy —

তবে সব ভক্ত তারে অঙ্গীকার কৈলা ।
তার গুণ কহি' মহাপ্রভুরে মিলাইলা ॥ ১৫৭ ॥

tabe saba bhakta tāre aṅgīkāra kailā
then all devotees him accepted
tāra guṇa kahi' mahāprabhure milāilā
his qualities telling with Mahāprabhu introduced

157 All the devotees then accepted him and, speaking of his good qualities, introduced him to Mahāprabhu.

*The poet accepts the *dharma* of *sannyāsa* and lives in Purī —*

সেই কবি সর্ব্ব ত্যজি' রহিলা নীলাচলে ।
গৌরভক্তগণের কৃপা কে কহিতে পারে ? ॥ ১৫৮ ॥

sei kavi sarva tyaji' rahilā nīlācale
that poet everything giving up stayed in Nīlācala
gaura-bhakta-gaṇera kṛpā ke kahite pāre?
of Gaura's devotees the mercy who to describe can

158 The poet gave up everything and remained in Nīlācala. Who can describe the mercy of Gaura's devotees?

Described: the pastime of Miśra's hearing about Kṛṣṇa, and Rāmānanda's

glory —

এই ত' কহিলুঁ প্রদ্যুম্নমিশ্র-বিবরণ ।
প্রভুর আজ্ঞায় কৈল কৃষ্ণকথার শ্রবণ ॥ ১৫৯ ॥

ei ta' kahiluṁ pradyumna-miśra-vivaraṇa
thus indeed I have told of Pradyumna Miśra the account
prabhura ājñāya kaila kṛṣṇa-kathāra śravaṇa
by the Lord's order he did of Kṛṣṇa-kathā the hearing

159 Thus I have told the account of Pradyumna Miśra, who by the Lord's order heard talks about Kṛṣṇa.

তার মধ্যে কহিলুঁ রামানন্দের মহিমা ।
আপনে শ্রীমুখে প্রভু বর্ণে যাঁর সীমা ॥ ১৬০ ॥

tāra madhye kahiluṁ rāmānandera mahimā
within that I have told Rāmānanda's glory
āpane śrī-mukhe prabhu varṇe yāṁra sīmā
Himself with His holy mouth the Lord describes whose limit

160 Within it I have spoken of the glory of Rāmānanda, the full extent of which the Lord Himself described with His own holy lips.

Through faith in the Vaiṣṇavas even an unlearned poet receives the Lord's mercy —

প্রস্তাবে কহিলুঁ কবির নাটক-বিবরণ ।
অজ্ঞ হঞা শ্রদ্ধায় পাইল প্রভুর চরণ ॥ ১৬১ ॥

prastāve kahiluṁ kavira nāṭaka-vivaraṇa
in passing I have told the poet's drama account
ajña hañā śraddhāya pāila prabhura caraṇa
ignorant being by faith obtained the Lord's feet

161 In passing I have also related the story of the poet's drama: ignorant though he was, by faith he attained the Lord's feet.

*By hearing and chanting Caitanya's pastimes with faith, one attains *sambandha*, *abhidheya* and *prayojana* —*

শ্রীকৃষ্ণচৈতন্য-লীলা — অমৃতের সার ।
একলীলা-প্রবাহে বহে শত-শত ধার ॥ ১৬২ ॥

śrī-kṛṣṇa-caitanya-līlā — amṛtera sāra
Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya's pastimes — of nectar the essence
ekalīlā-pravāhe vahe śata-śata dhāra
of a single pastime in the stream flow hundreds upon hundreds of currents

162 The pastimes of Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya are the essence of nectar: from the stream of a single pastime flow hundreds upon hundreds of currents.

Anubhāṣya.
Thus ends the fifth chapter of the "Anubhāṣya."

শ্রদ্ধা করি' এই লীলা যেই পড়ে, শুনে ।
গৌরলীলা, ভক্তি, ভক্ত, রস-তত্ত্ব জানে ॥ ১৬৩ ॥

śraddhā kari' ei līlā yei paḍe, śune
faith having this pastime whoever reads hears
gaura-līlā, bhakti, bhakta, rasa-tattva jāne
Gaura's pastimes bhakti the devotees the truth of rasa knows

163 Whoever reads or hears this pastime with faith comes to know the pastimes of Gaura, bhakti, the devotees and the truth of rasa.

শ্রীরূপ-রঘুনাথ-পদে যার আশ ।
চৈতন্যচরিতামৃত কহে কৃষ্ণদাস ॥ ১৬৪ ॥

śrī-rūpa-raghunātha-pade yāra āśa
Śrī Rūpa's, Raghunātha's at the feet whose hope
caitanya-caritāmṛta kahe kṛṣṇadāsa
"Caitanya-caritāmṛta" narrates Kṛṣṇadāsa

164 Praying at the feet of Śrī Rūpa and Śrī Raghunātha, I, Kṛṣṇadāsa, narrate the *Caitanya-caritāmṛta*.

Notes

1. The Gauḍīya Maṭha edition reads “তাহাদের সব সেবা”, “every service for them” ↩
2. The second line is the same as Madhya 13.67; translation as there. ↩
3. The Gauḍīya Maṭha edition reads “লঞা আইলা শুনাইতে”, without “প্রভুকে” (“to the Lord”). ↩
4. The Gauḍīya Maṭha edition reads “এক কবি”, “a poet” (the text Vṛndāvana Candra dāsa followed has “এক বিপ্র”, “a brāhmaṇa”). ↩
5. = Madhya 25.36; translation as there. ↩
6. = Madhya 25.37; translation as there. ↩
7. = Madhya 18.114; translation as there. ↩
8. *Dāru-brahma* — the Brahman manifest in a form of sacred wood (*dāru*); to see in the Deity only a wooden image is an offence (*Anubhāṣya*, see 118). ↩
9. *Bṛhad-āraṇyaka Upaniṣad* 2.1.20. ↩
10. *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 1.2.11 (CC, Ādi 2.11). ↩
11. *Stobha* is one kind of *nāmābhāsa*: the Name uttered not for its own sake (literally, “a filler syllable in a chant”); compare *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 6.2.14. ↩